Visual Vocabulary for ThoughtSpot

A guide to chart types in ThoughtSpot.

This Liveboard is inspired by the Financial Times' Visual Vocabulary, adapted and reimagined for ThoughtSpot. Not every chart from the original made it in. Some shifted categories, and a few are entirely new.

Browse by analytical purpose to find the right chart for your data story: comparisons, distributions, relationships, flows, and more.

All charts are built in Muze Studio. Most visualizations use native Muze marks and support ThoughtSpot filtering and drilldown. Select charts use custom SVG or other rendering approaches and may not support those native interactions.

Note: AI tools, including Muze AI and ChatGPT, were used to assist with custom chart formatting and this Overview page.

Deviation

Show how values differ from a reference, target, or average.

Correlation

Explore relationships between two or more variables.

Ranking

Compare the relative position of categories or items.

Distribution

Understand frequencies, spread, clusters, and outliers.

Change over Time

Show how values or patterns evolve over time.

Part-to-Whole

Show how individual components contribute to a total.

Magnitude

Compare the size of quantitative values.

Spatial

Explore geographic patterns, locations, and concentrations.

Flow

Illustrate movement, transitions, and connections.

Based on the FT Visual Vocabulary by Alan Smith, Chris Campbell, Ian Bott, Liz Faunce, Graham Parrish, Billy Ehrenberg, Paul McCallum, and Martin Stabe. Inspired by the Graphic Continuum by Jon Schwabish and Severino Ribecca.

Additional inspiration from Andy Kriebel's Tableau adaptation of Visual Vocabulary on Tableau Public.

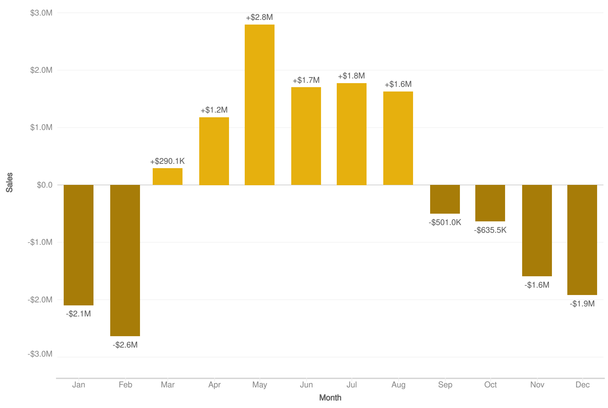
Deviation

Standard Deviation Charts

Use reference, target, and difference charts to identify departures from expected or baseline values.

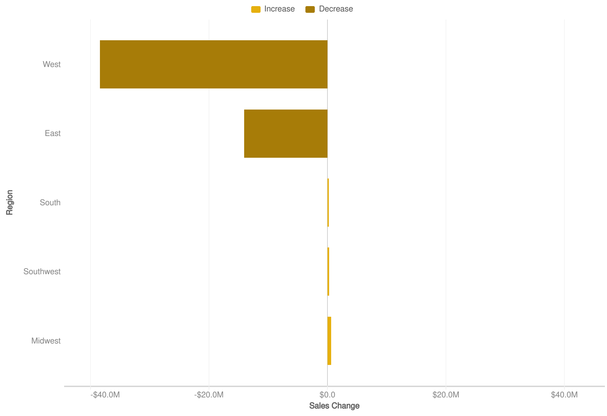
Deviation Bar

Shows positive and negative changes from a baseline, making it easy to spot gains and losses at a glance.



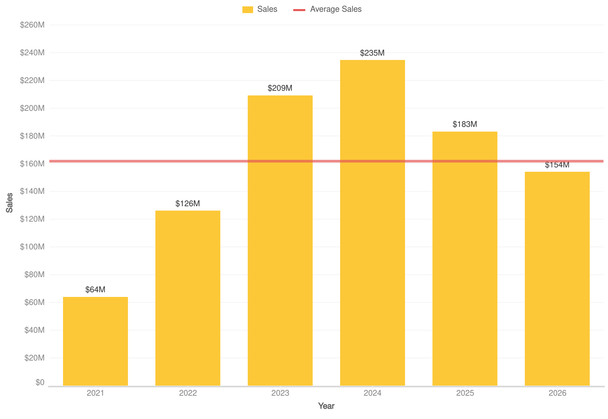
Diverging Bar

Places positive and negative differences on opposite sides of a common baseline to compare the direction and size of changes.



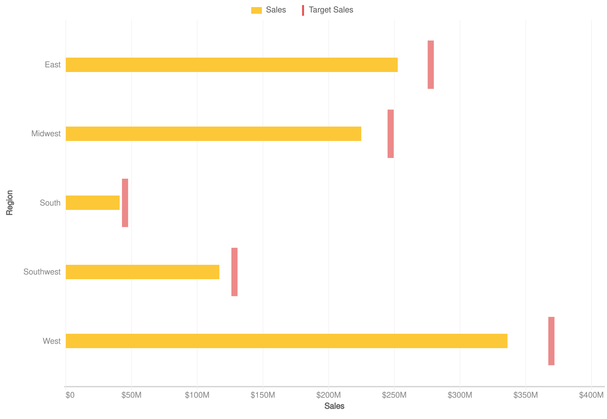
Bar with Reference Line

Plots a trend line with a fixed reference line to flag where values cross key thresholds or benchmarks.



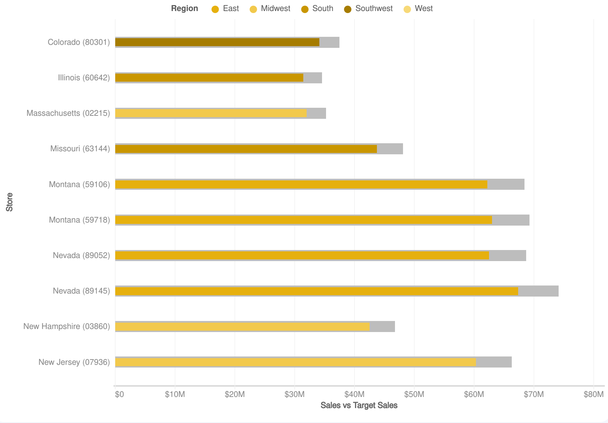
Bar and Tick

Combines bars with tick marks to compare actual values against targets on a shared scale.



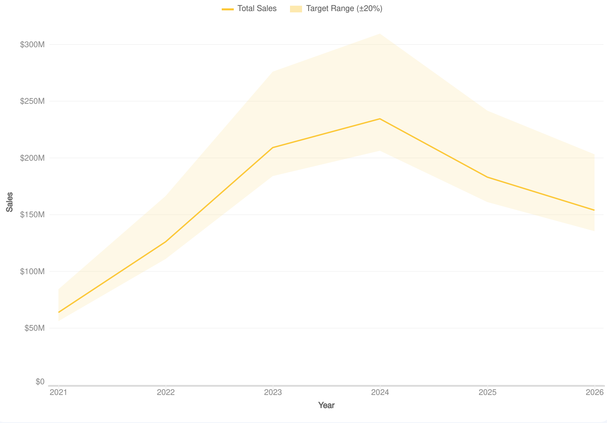
Bullet

A compact gauge that plots a primary measure against a target and qualitative ranges for quick performance assessment.



Ranged Area with Line

Highlights a value band over time with a line overlay, revealing variability and how actuals track within an expected range.

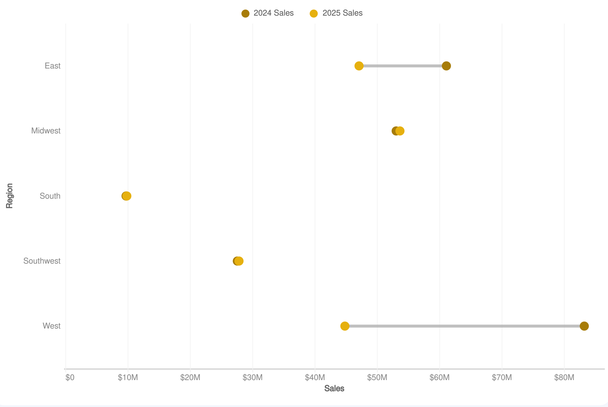


Advanced Deviation Charts

Use paired comparisons and bridge charts to explain differences between groups and the drivers of overall change.

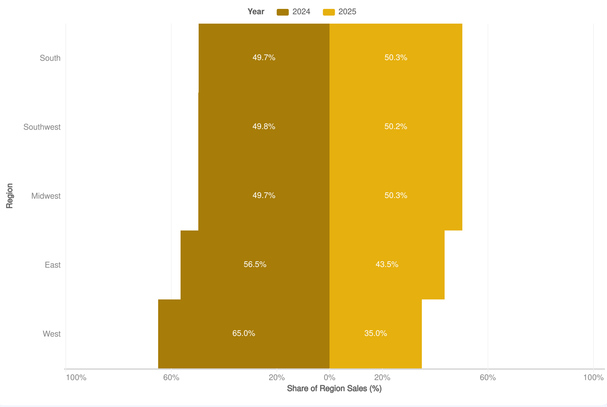
Dumbbell

Connects two values for each category to make differences between periods, scenarios, or groups easy to compare.



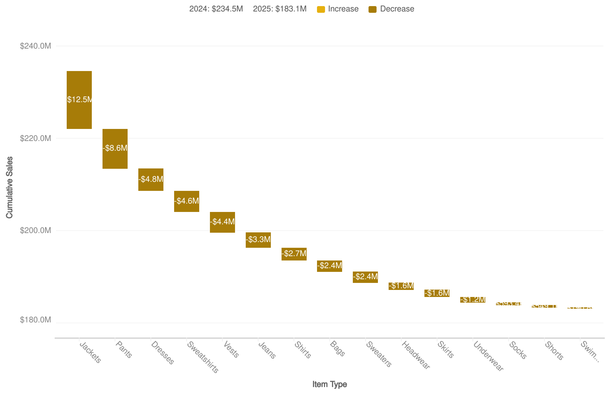
Spine

Places proportional segments around a shared center line to compare how composition differs between groups.



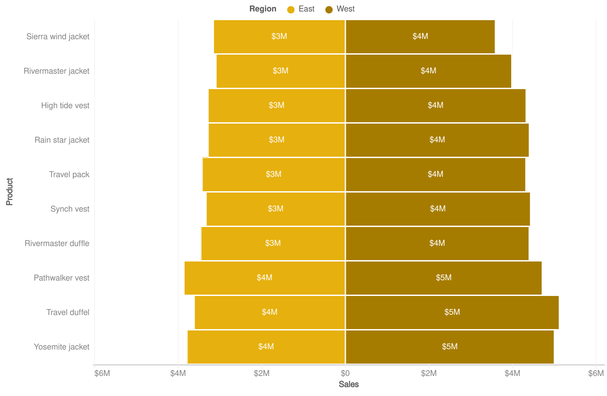
Variance Waterfall

Bridges two totals with floating contribution bars to explain which categories drove the net change.



Mirrored Bar (Population Pyramid)

Aligns two distributions on opposite sides of a common baseline for direct comparison across categories.



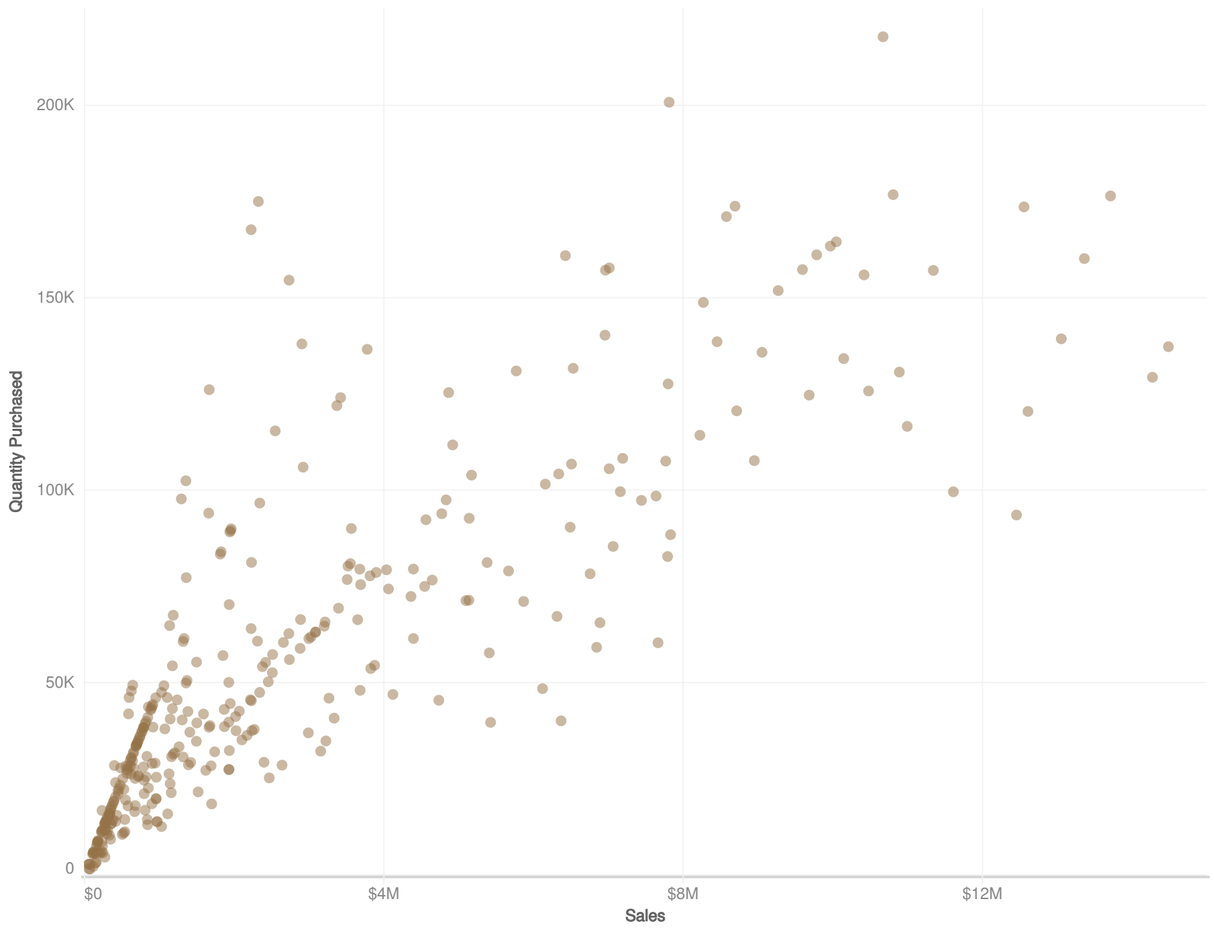
Correlation

Standard Correlation Charts

Use scatterplots, bubbles, and heatmaps to examine associations and patterns between variables.

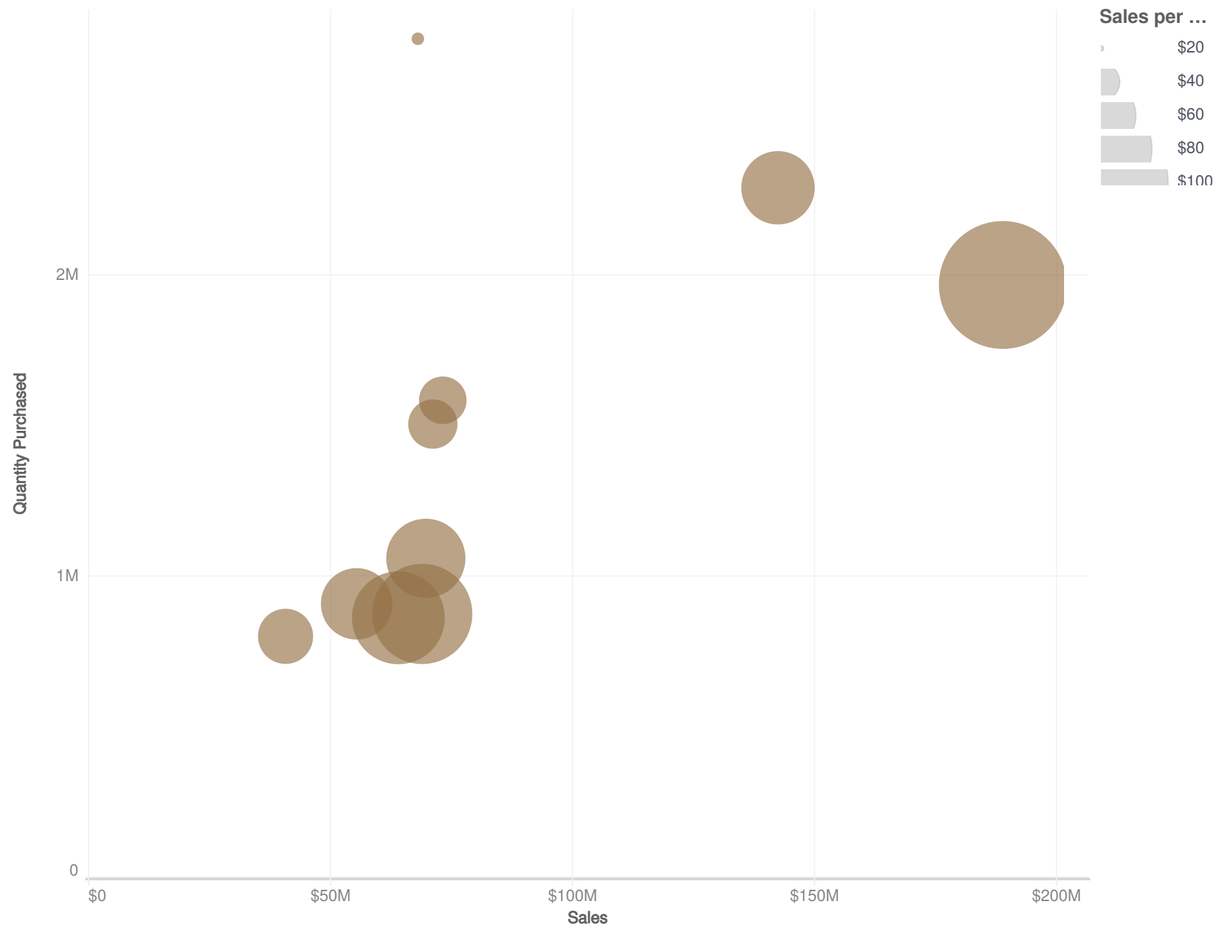
Scatterplot

Plots individual data points on two axes to reveal correlations, clusters, and outliers between two measures.



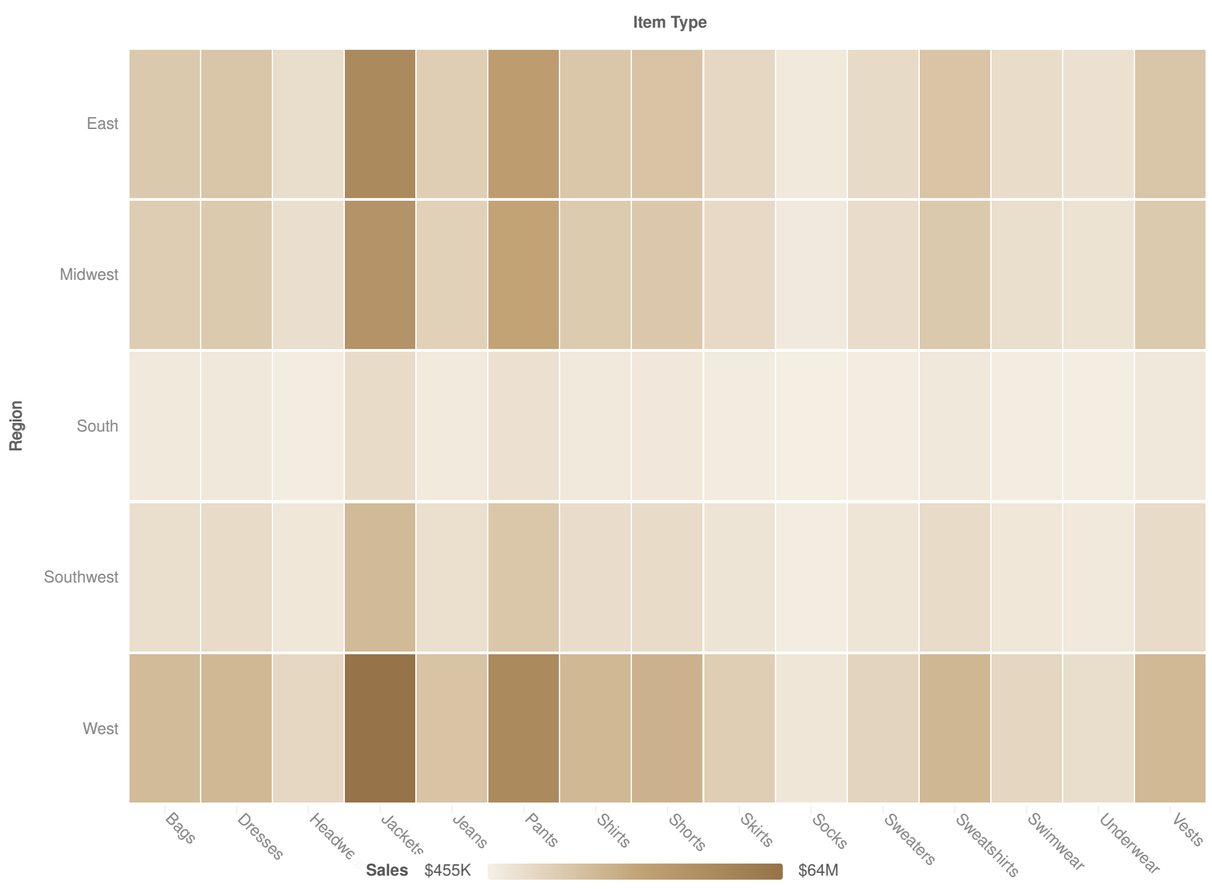
Bubble

Like a scatterplot but adds bubble size as a third variable, showing the magnitude of each data point.



Heatmap

Uses color intensity across a grid to show how a measure varies across two categorical dimensions.

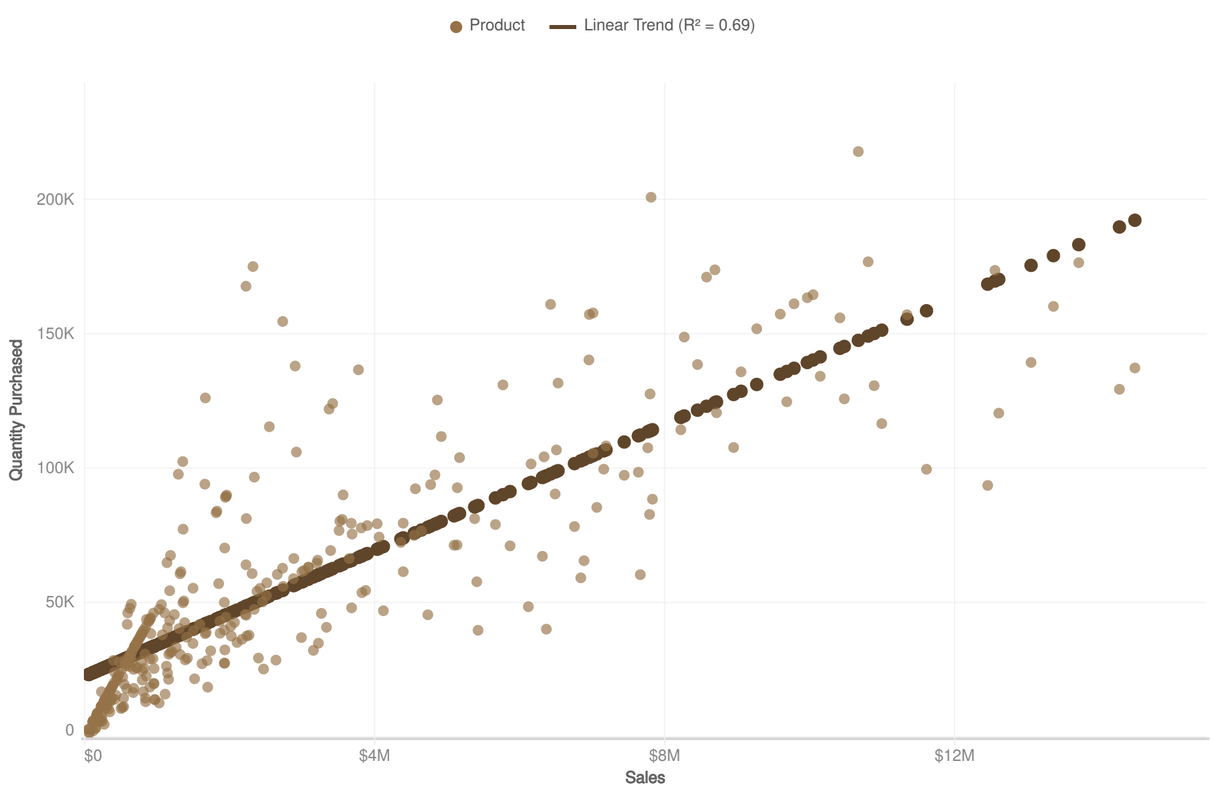


Advanced Correlation Charts

Use regression and multivariate views to investigate complex relationships, compare several measures, and spot outliers.

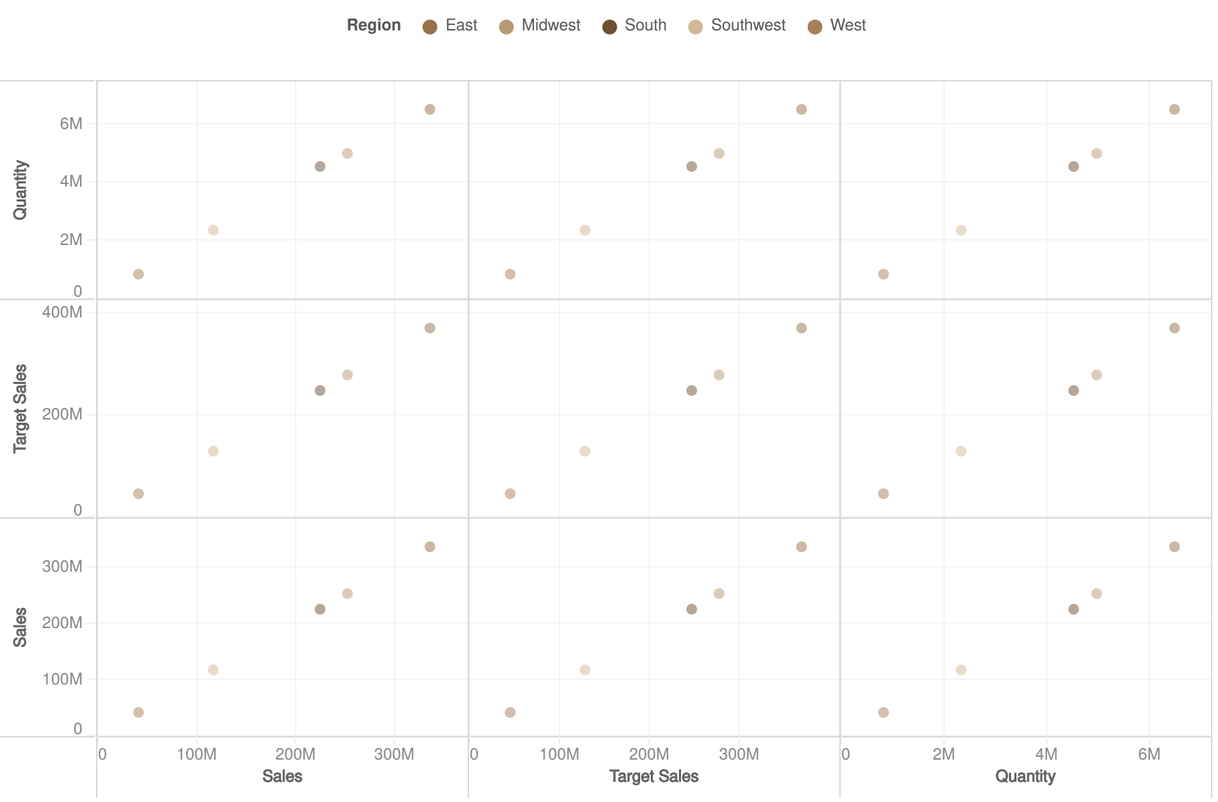
Scatterplot with Regression Line

Adds a fitted regression line to a scatterplot to assess the direction and strength of a linear relationship.



Scatterplot Matrix

Arranges scatterplots for every pair of measures to explore multivariate relationships and potential correlations.



Parallel Coordinates

Compares multiple quantitative measures across categories using connected lines, revealing patterns, relationships, and outliers.

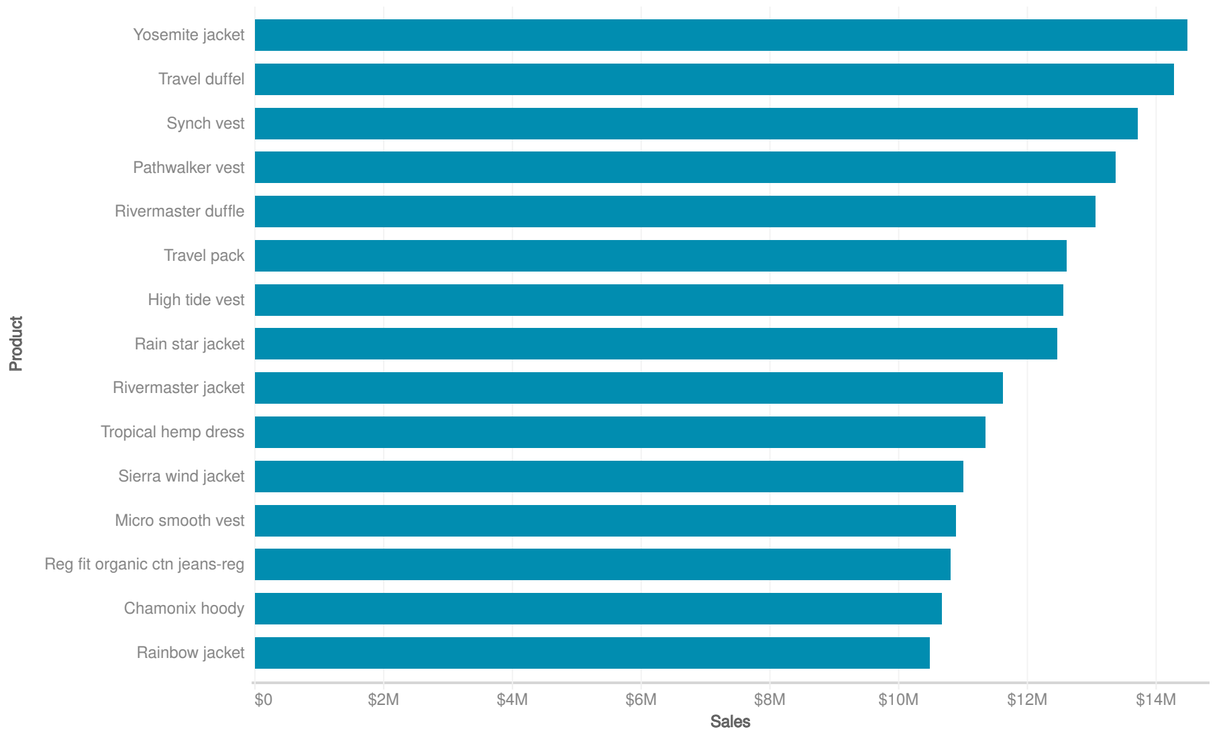
Ranking

Standard Ranking Charts

Use ordered bars and columns to compare rank positions, highlight leading categories, and identify concentration.

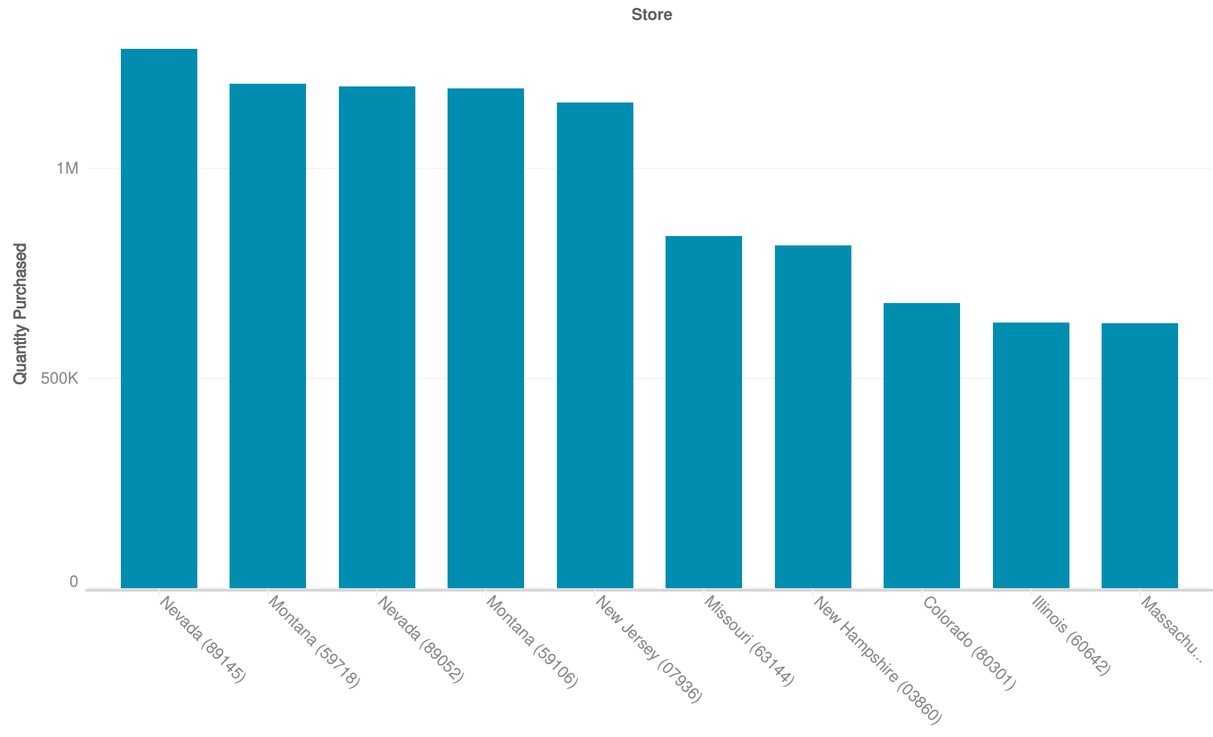
Ordered Bar

Ranks categories with horizontal bars sorted by value, making it easy to compare and identify top or bottom performers.



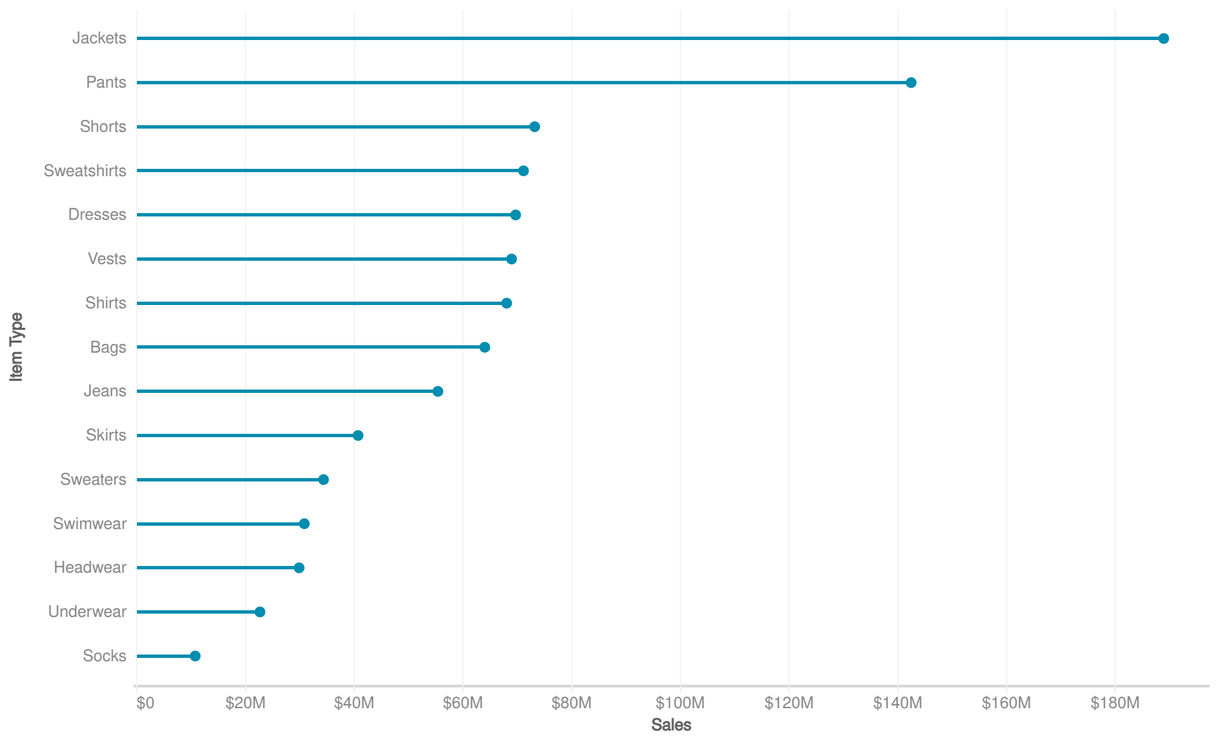
Ordered Column

Ranks categories with vertical bars sorted by value, ideal for spotting leaders and laggards at a glance.



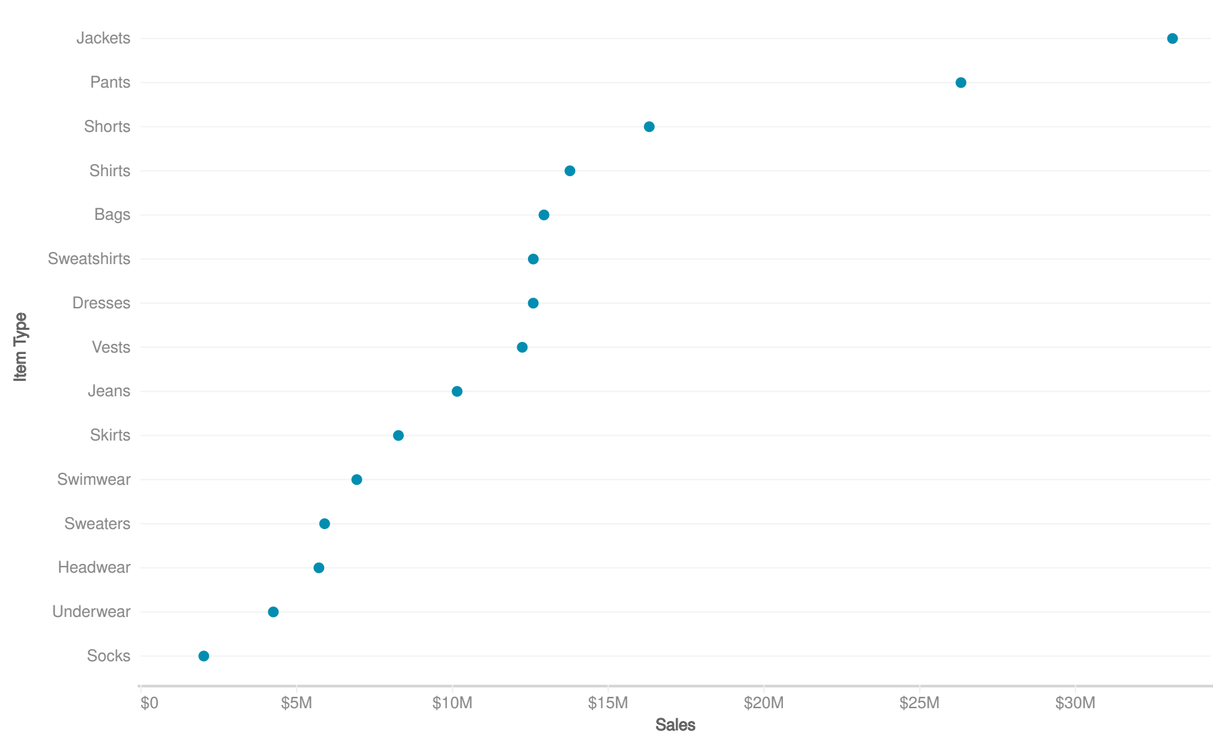
Lollipop

Ranks or compares categories with dots and thin stems, offering a lighter alternative to conventional bars.



Dot Plot

Places one dot per category on a shared numeric scale to compare values precisely with minimal visual clutter.

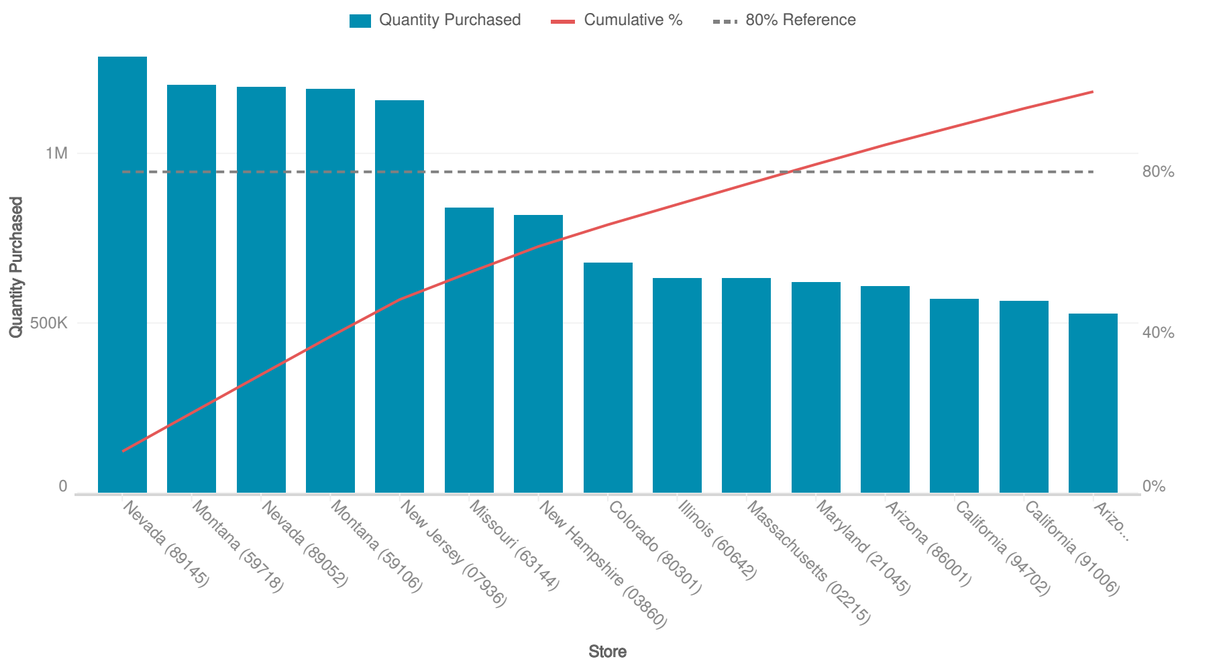


Advanced Ranking Charts

Use cumulative, slope, and rank-transition charts to explore which categories dominate and how positions change.

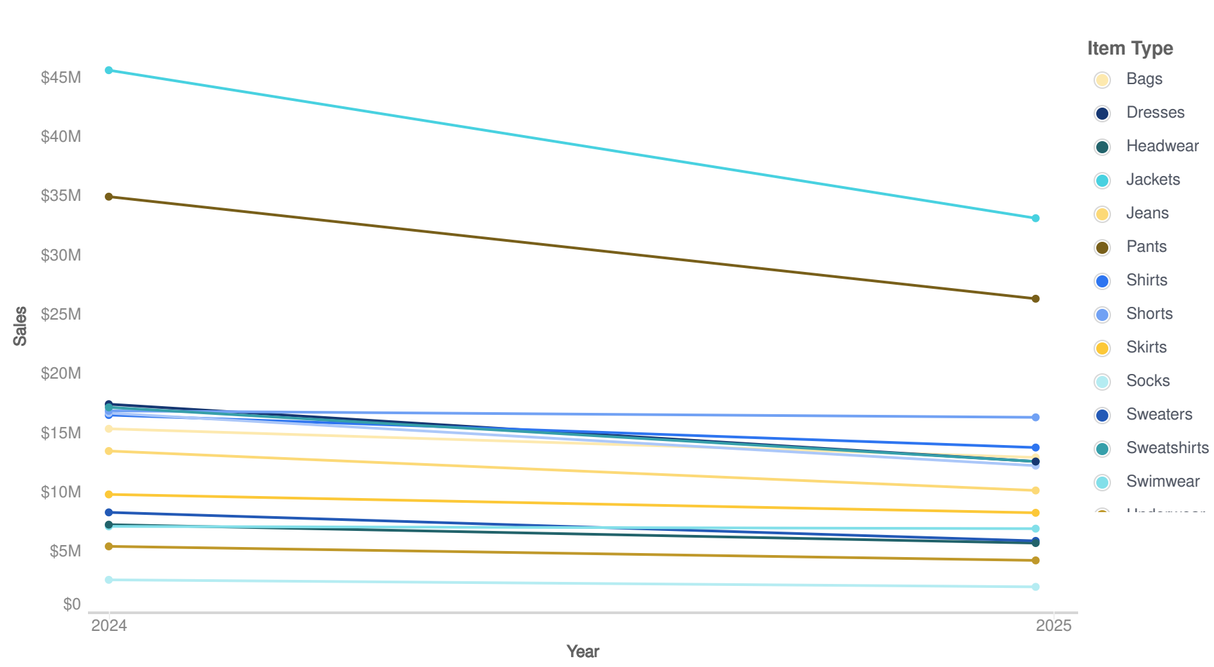
Pareto

Combines sorted bars with a cumulative line to show which categories contribute the most under the 80/20 rule.



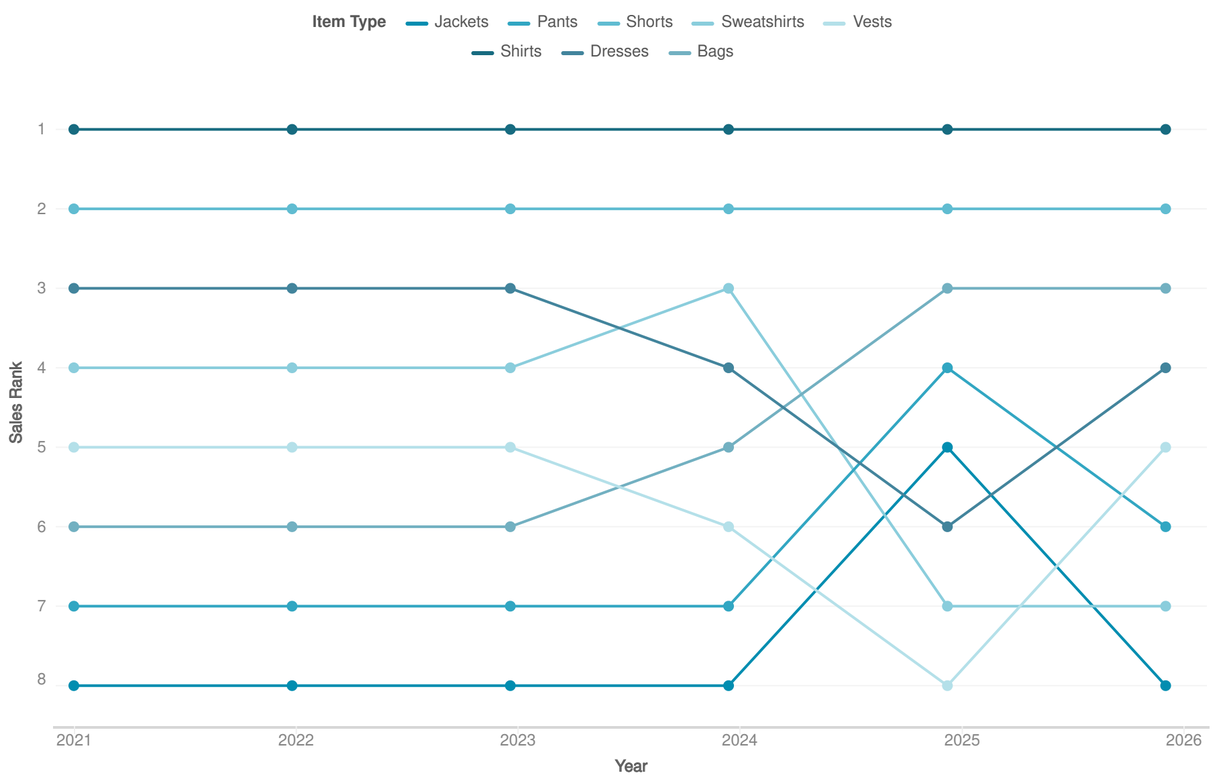
Slope

Connects category values at two points in time to reveal increases, decreases, and changes in relative position.



Bump

Connects rankings over successive periods to show which categories rise, fall, or exchange positions.



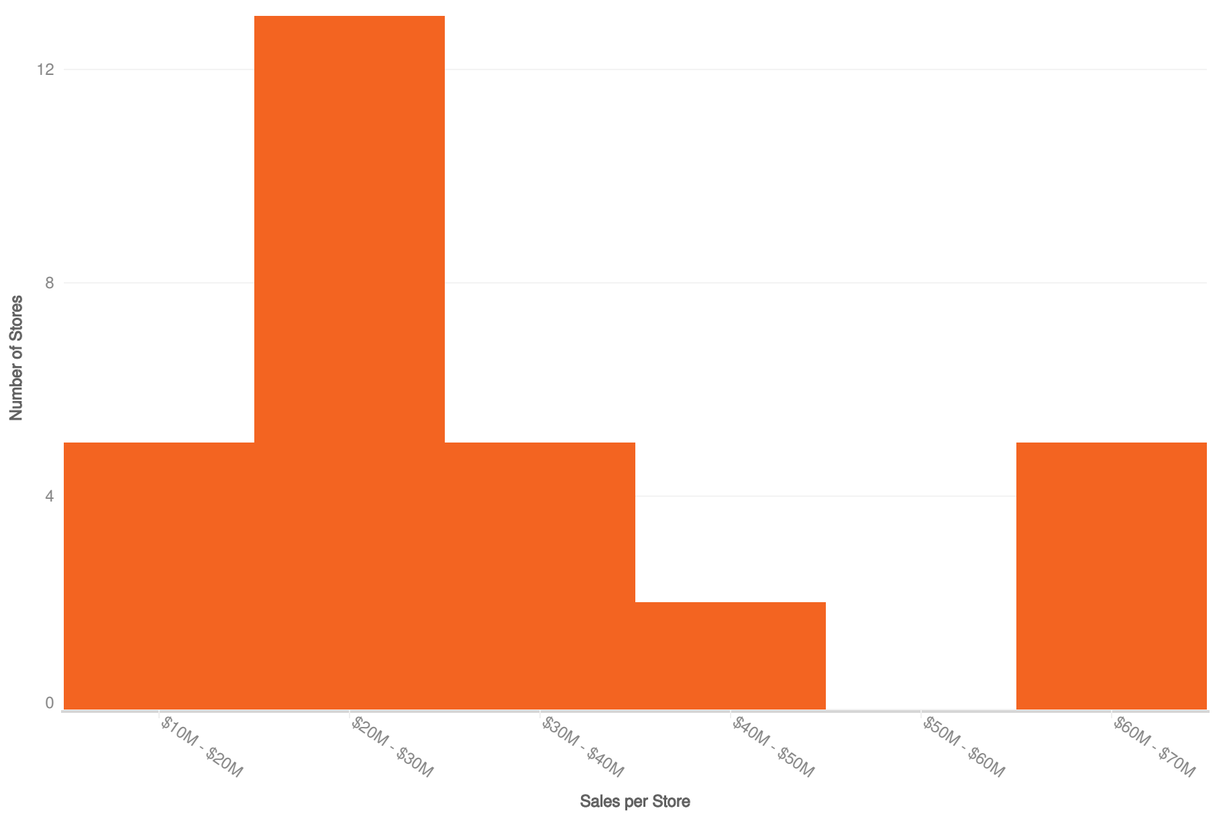
Distribution

Standard Distribution Charts

Use frequency and spread charts to examine the shape of a distribution and identify outliers or clusters.

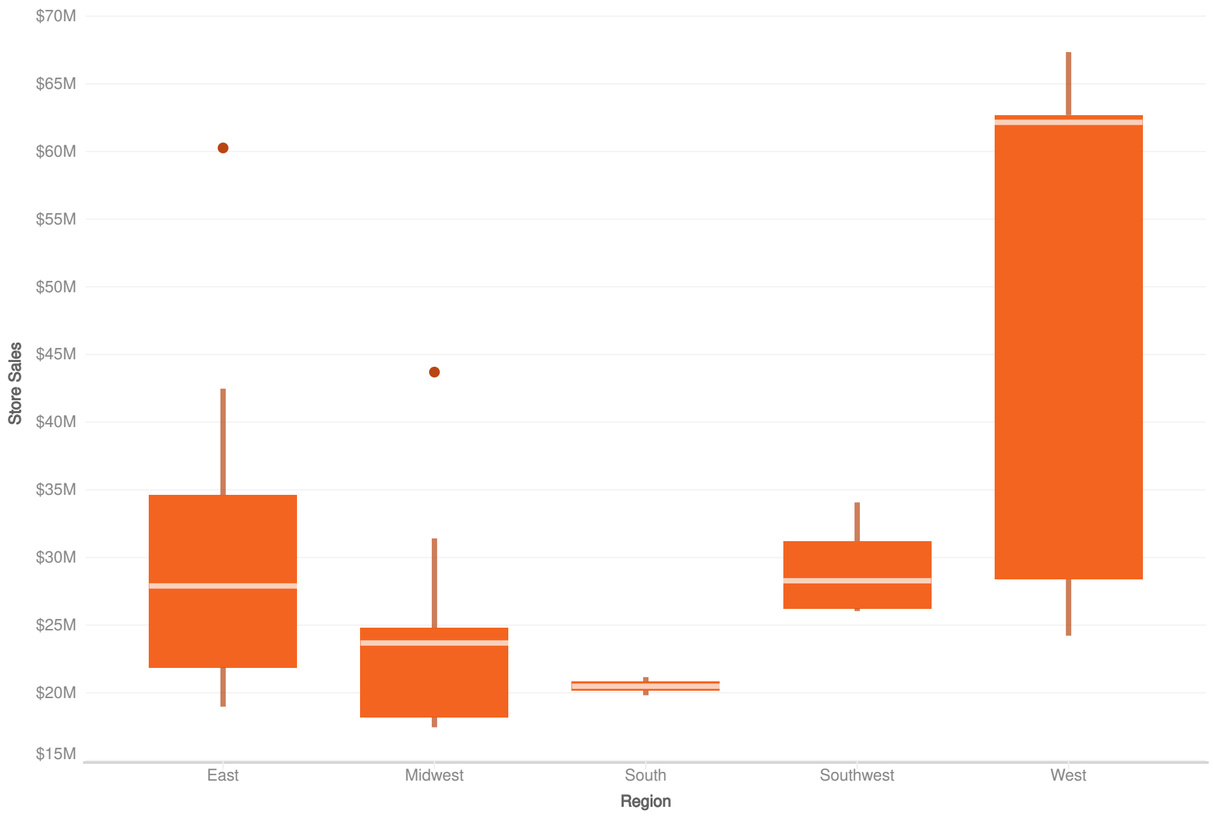
Histogram

Groups continuous observations into numeric bins to reveal frequency, skew, gaps, and the shape of a distribution.



Box Plot

Summarizes a distribution with its median, quartiles, whiskers, and potential outliers.



Strip Plot

Shows individual observations within each category to reveal spread, overlap, clusters, and outliers.

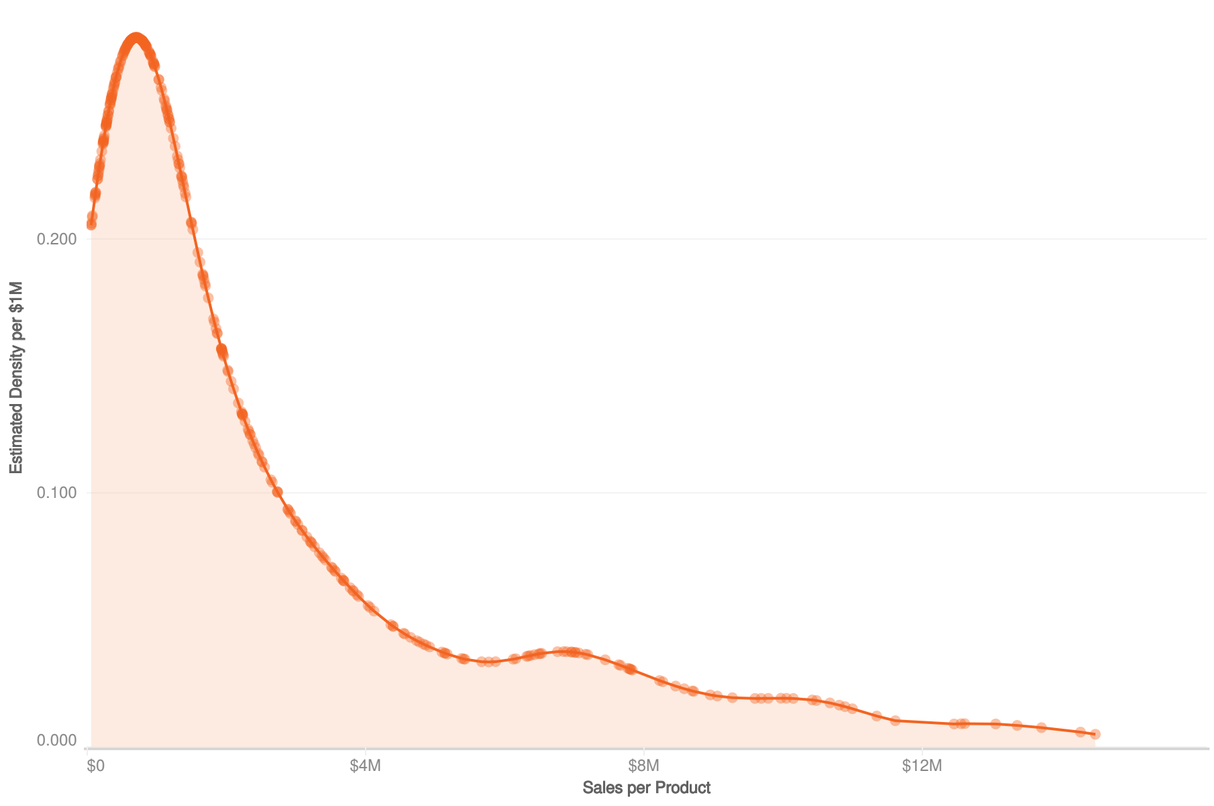


Advanced Distribution Charts

Use density, cumulative, and radial views to explore distribution shape, percentiles, and alternative magnitude comparisons.

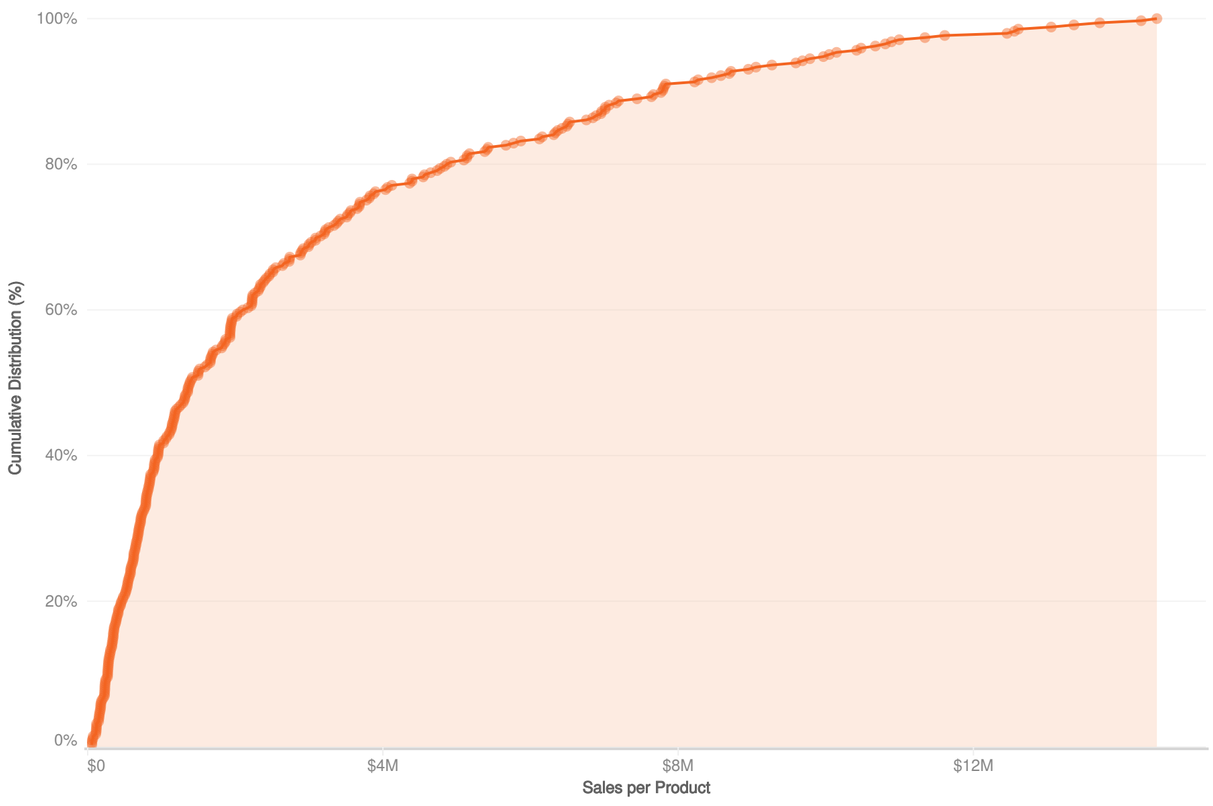
Density Plot

Uses a smoothed density curve to estimate the distribution of continuous observations and locate peaks or gaps.



Cumulative Distribution

Shows the cumulative share of observations at or below each value, useful for percentile and threshold analysis.



Polar Area

Uses wedges radiating from a center with varying radii to compare category magnitudes on a circular layout.

Change over Time

Standard Time Series Charts

Use foundational time-series charts to compare periods, track trends, and see how totals change over time.

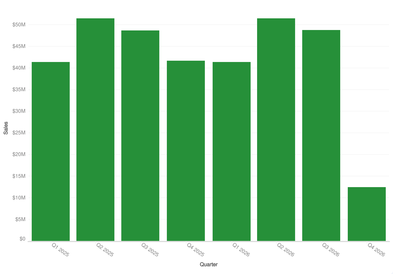
Line

Connects observations across time to show trends, turning points, and recurring patterns.



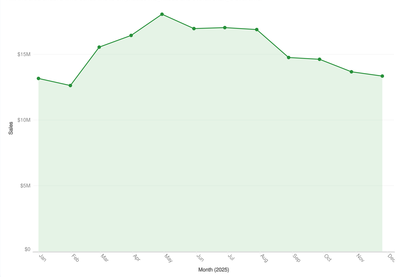
Column

Compares values across distinct time periods using equal-width vertical columns.



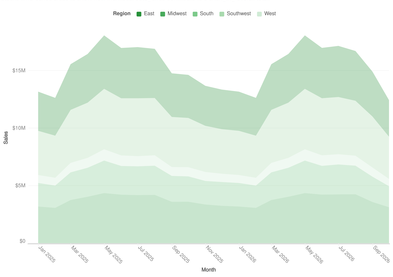
Area

Fills the area under a time-series line to emphasize magnitude and overall change over time.



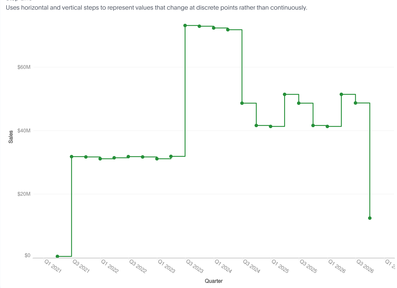
Stacked Area

Stacks time-series areas to show how individual categories contribute to a changing overall total.



Step Line

Uses horizontal and vertical steps to represent values that change at discrete points rather than continuously.

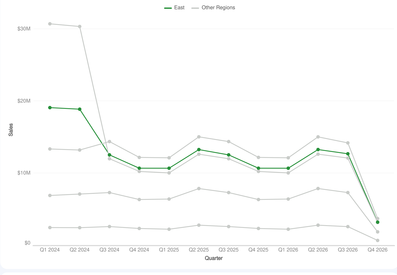


Advanced Time Series Charts

Use layered, faceted, and specialized time-series charts to explore trends, volatility, seasonality, and uncertainty.

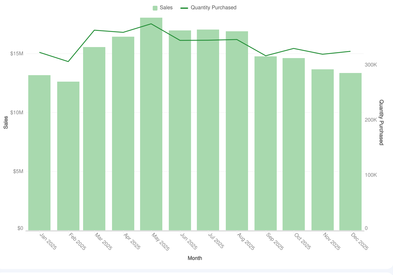
Highlighted Multi-Line

Emphasizes selected series among many lines to help compare a focal trend with the wider group.



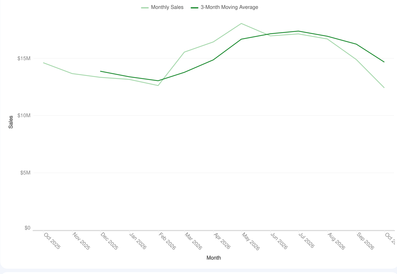
Line + Column

Combines sales columns with a quantity purchased line to compare revenue and purchase volume trends over time.



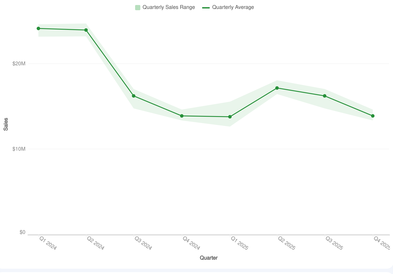
Line with Moving Average

Overlays a moving average on a time series to reduce short-term noise and reveal the underlying trend.



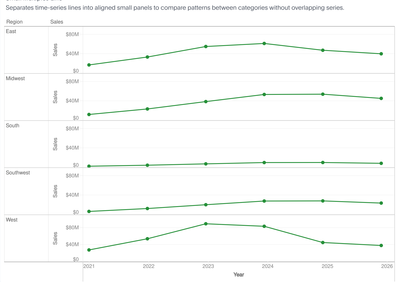
Ranged Area with Line

Combines a line with upper and lower bounds to show how a trend behaves within a range of variation or uncertainty.



Small Multiples Line

Separates time-series lines into aligned small panels to compare patterns between categories without overlapping series.



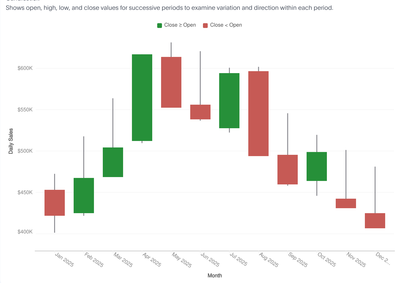
Calendar Heatmap

Colors days within a calendar layout to identify daily activity patterns, seasonal effects, and unusual dates.

Chart did not render
Check console logs for details

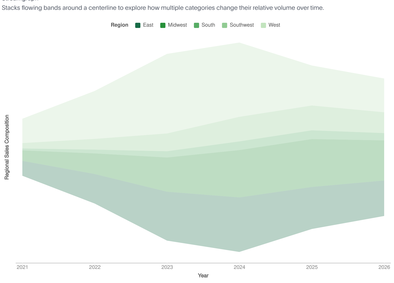
Candlestick

Shows open, high, low, and close values for successive periods to examine variation and direction within each period.



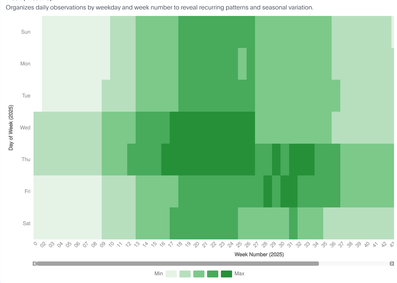
Streamgraph

Stacks flowing bands around a centerline to explore how multiple categories change their relative volume over time.



Weekly Heatmap

Organizes daily observations by weekday and week number to reveal recurring patterns and seasonal variation.



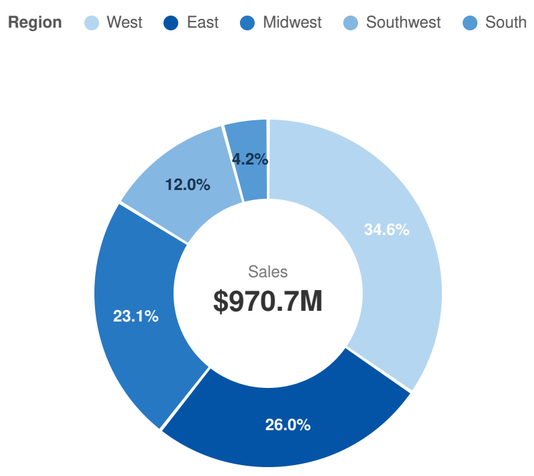
Part-to-Whole

Standard Part-to-Whole Charts

Use foundational part-to-whole charts to compare absolute and relative contributions to an overall total.

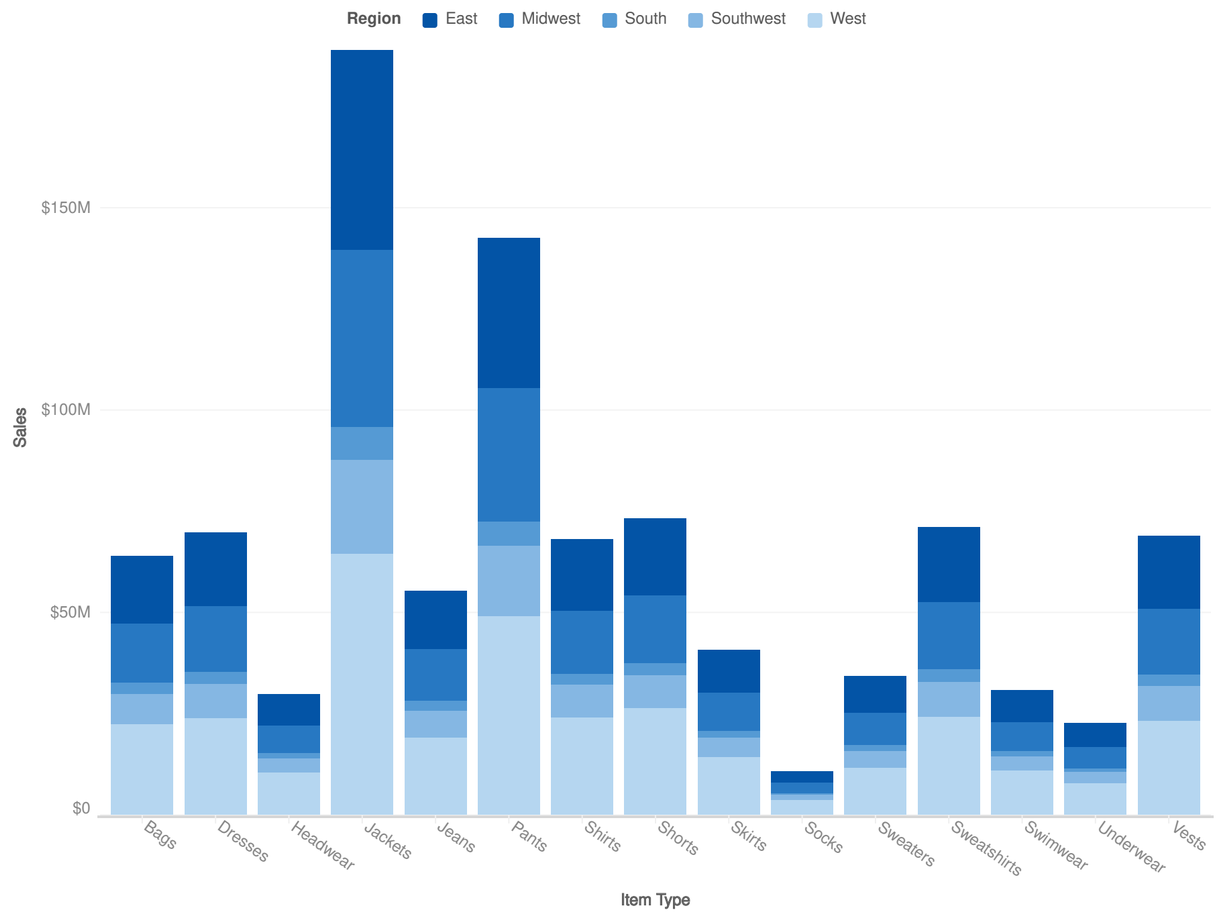
Donut

Displays part-to-whole proportions as circular segments around a central space for a summary metric or annotation.



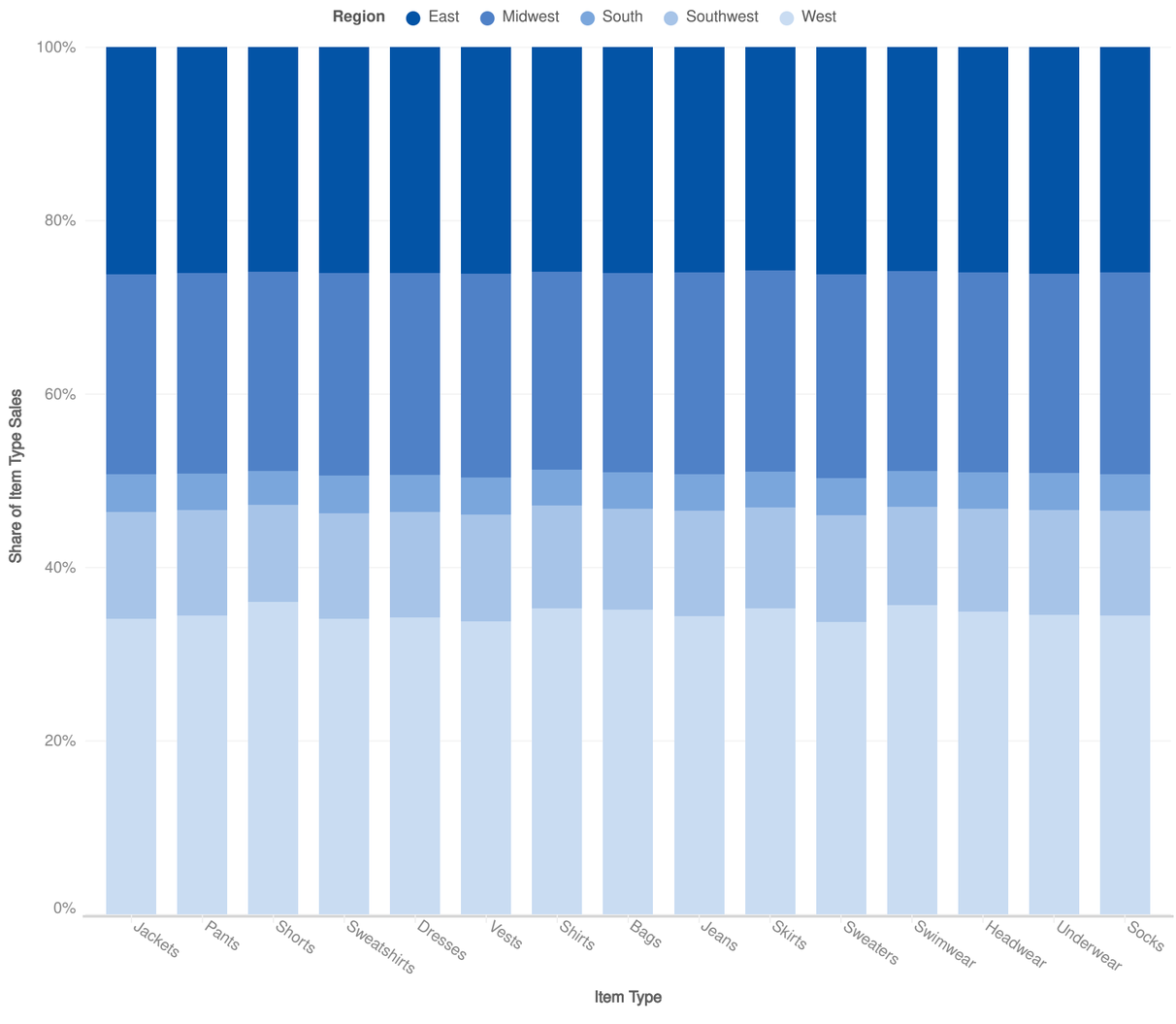
Stacked Column

Stacks category segments within each column to show both individual parts and the combined total per group.



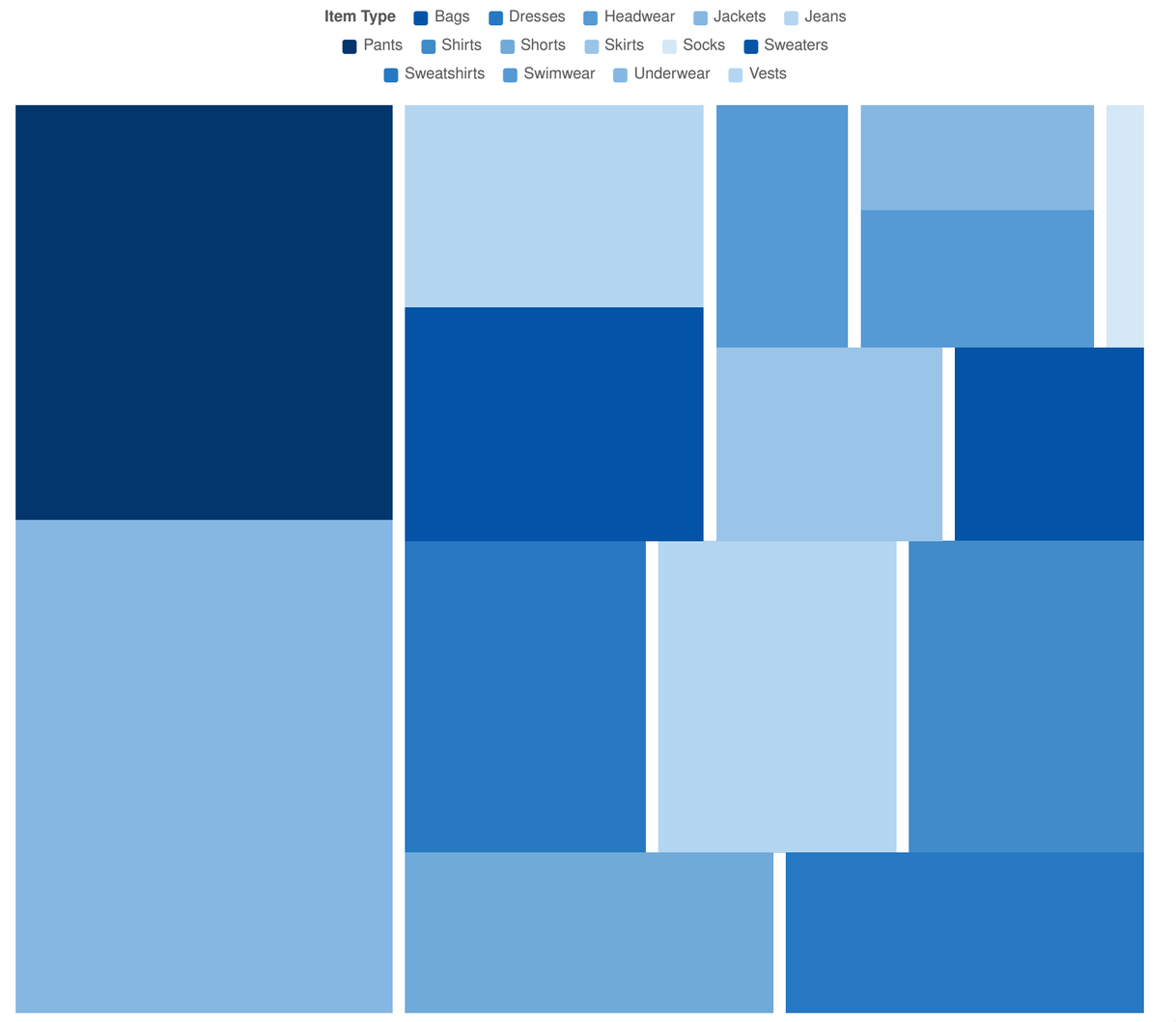
100% Stacked Column

Normalizes stacked columns to 100% to compare relative category composition independent of group size.



Treemap

Uses nested rectangles sized by value to compare contributions within a hierarchy or group of categories.

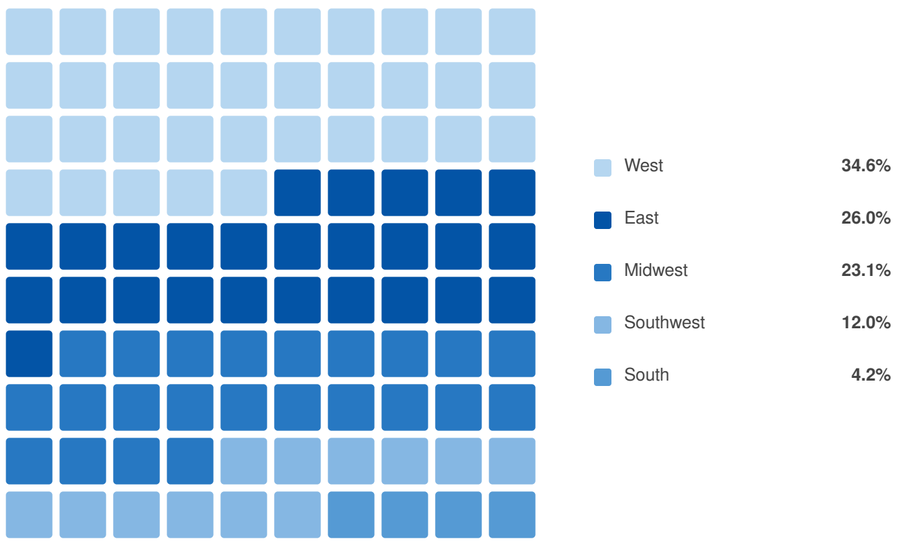


Advanced Part-to-Whole Charts

Use specialized proportion and hierarchy charts to examine composition across categories and multiple levels.

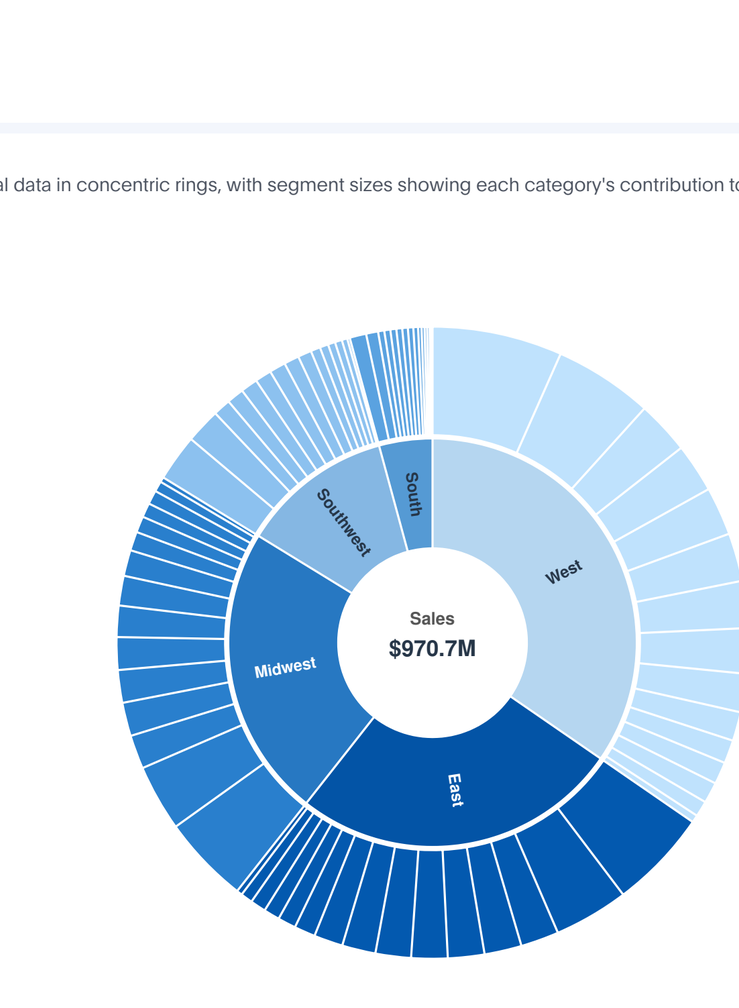
Waffle

Represents part-to-whole percentages with a fixed grid of equally sized squares for intuitive proportion comparisons.



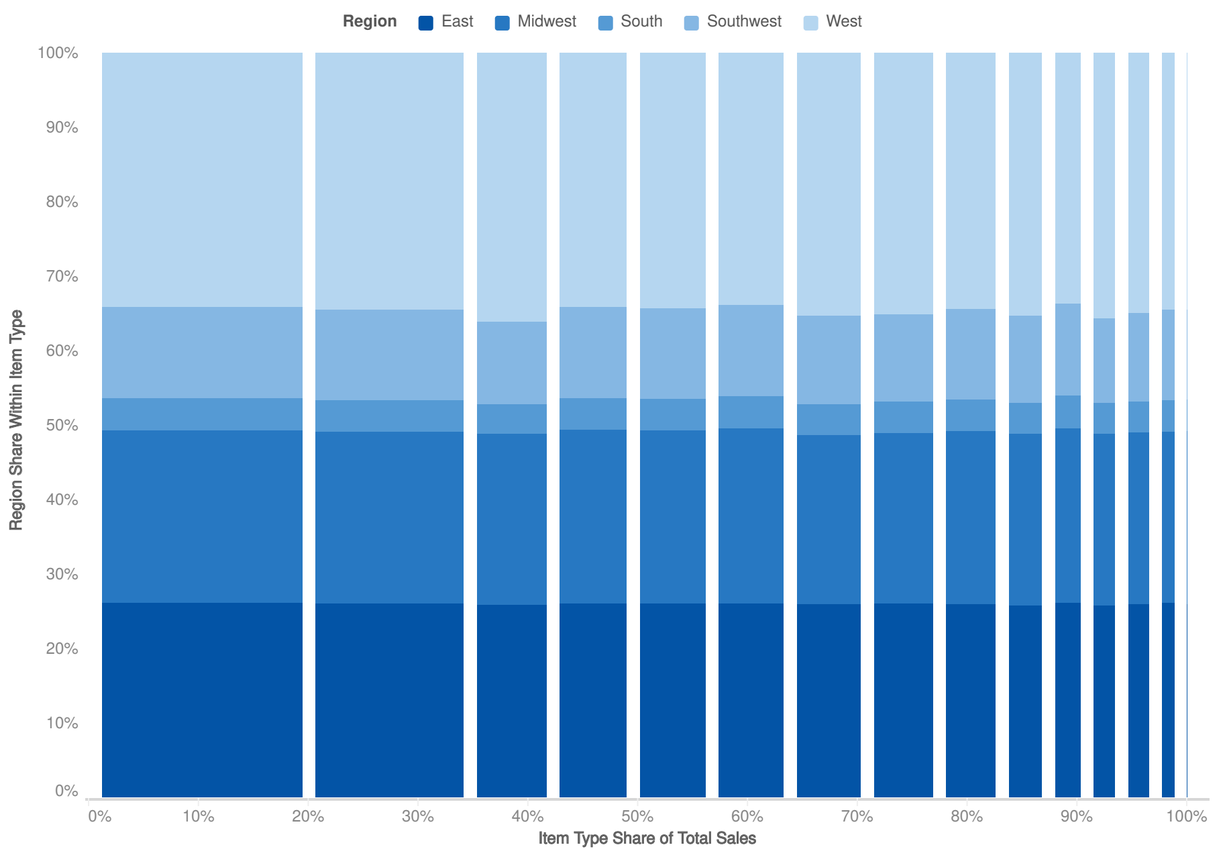
Arc

Displays part-to-whole proportions along a curved arc as an alternative to a conventional circular chart.



Proportional Stacked Bar or Marimekko

Uses variable-width columns with proportional segments to show both group size and composition in one chart.



Sunburst

Displays hierarchical data in concentric rings, with segment sizes showing each category's contribution to the total.

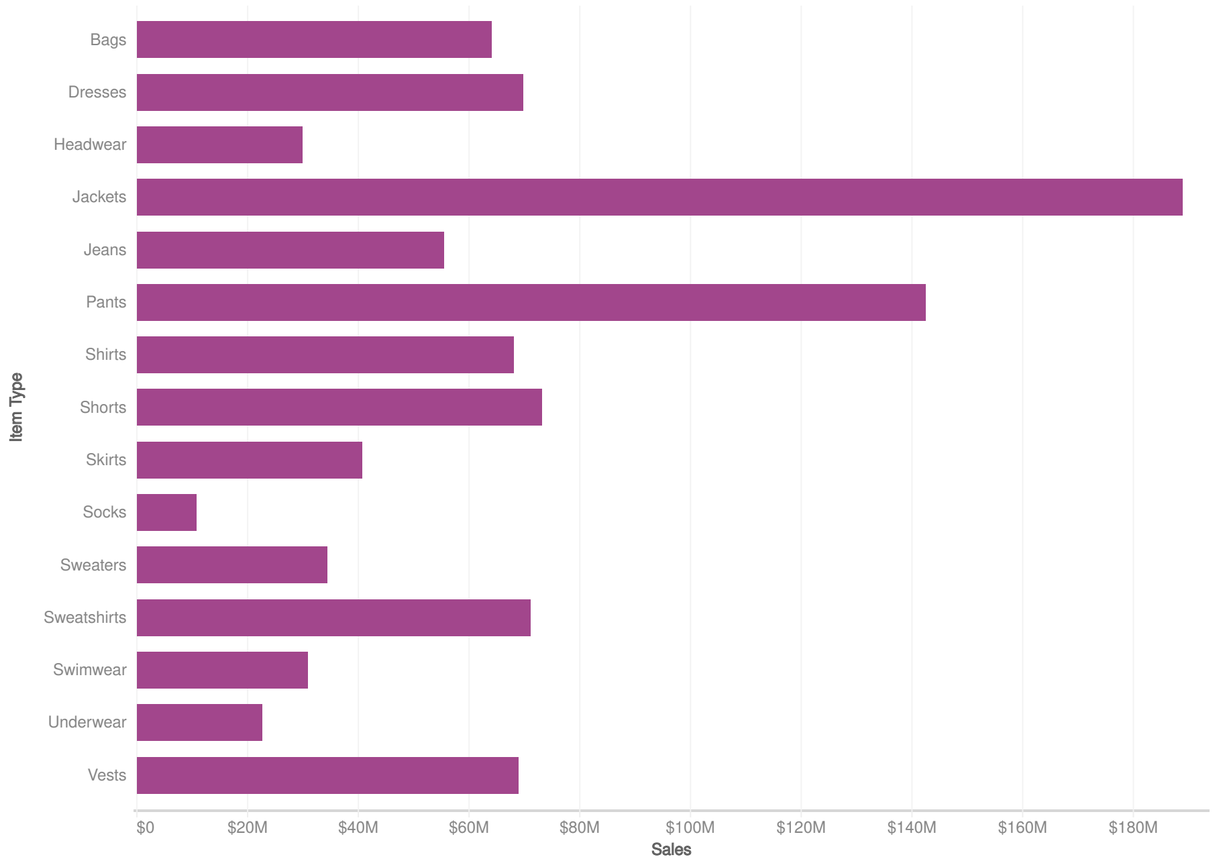
Magnitude

Standard Magnitude Charts

Use simple bars and grouped comparisons to judge the relative size of quantitative values across categories.

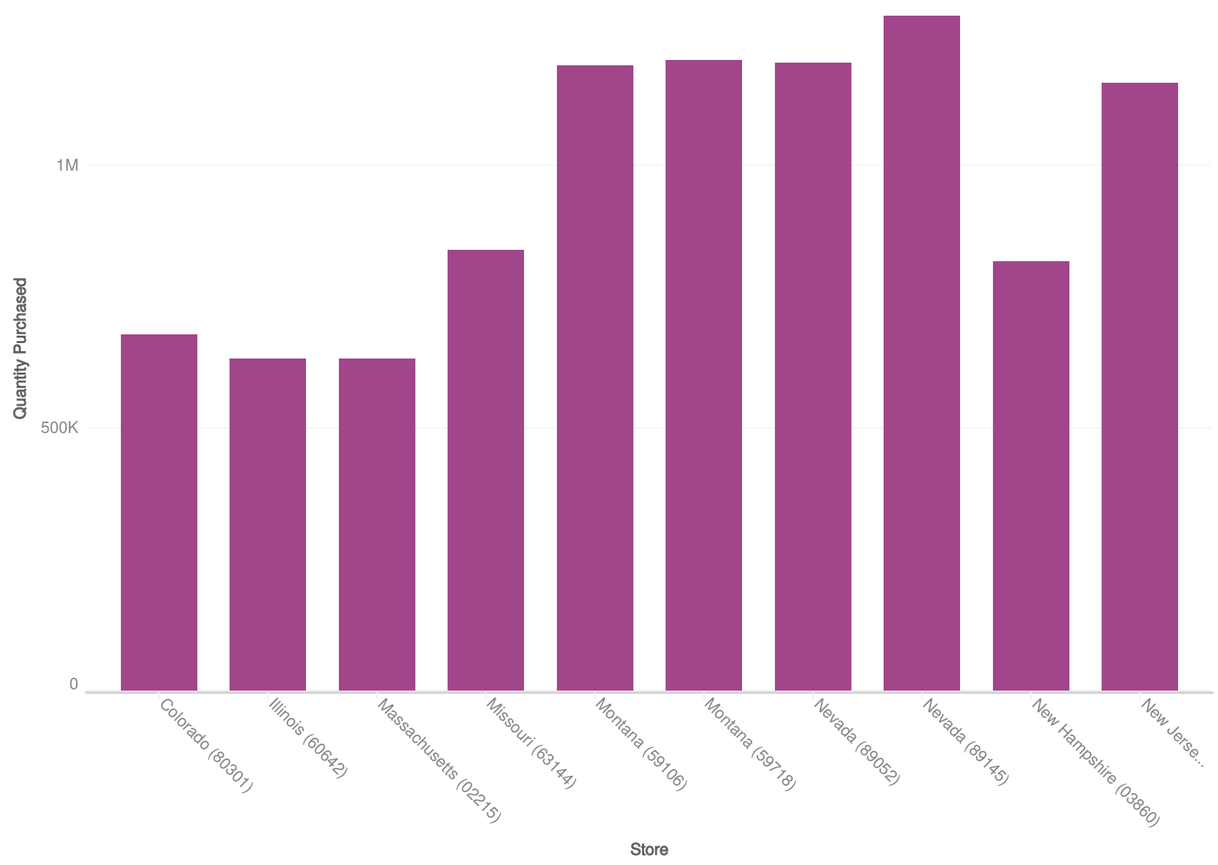
Bar

Uses horizontal bars on a shared baseline to compare quantitative magnitudes across categories.



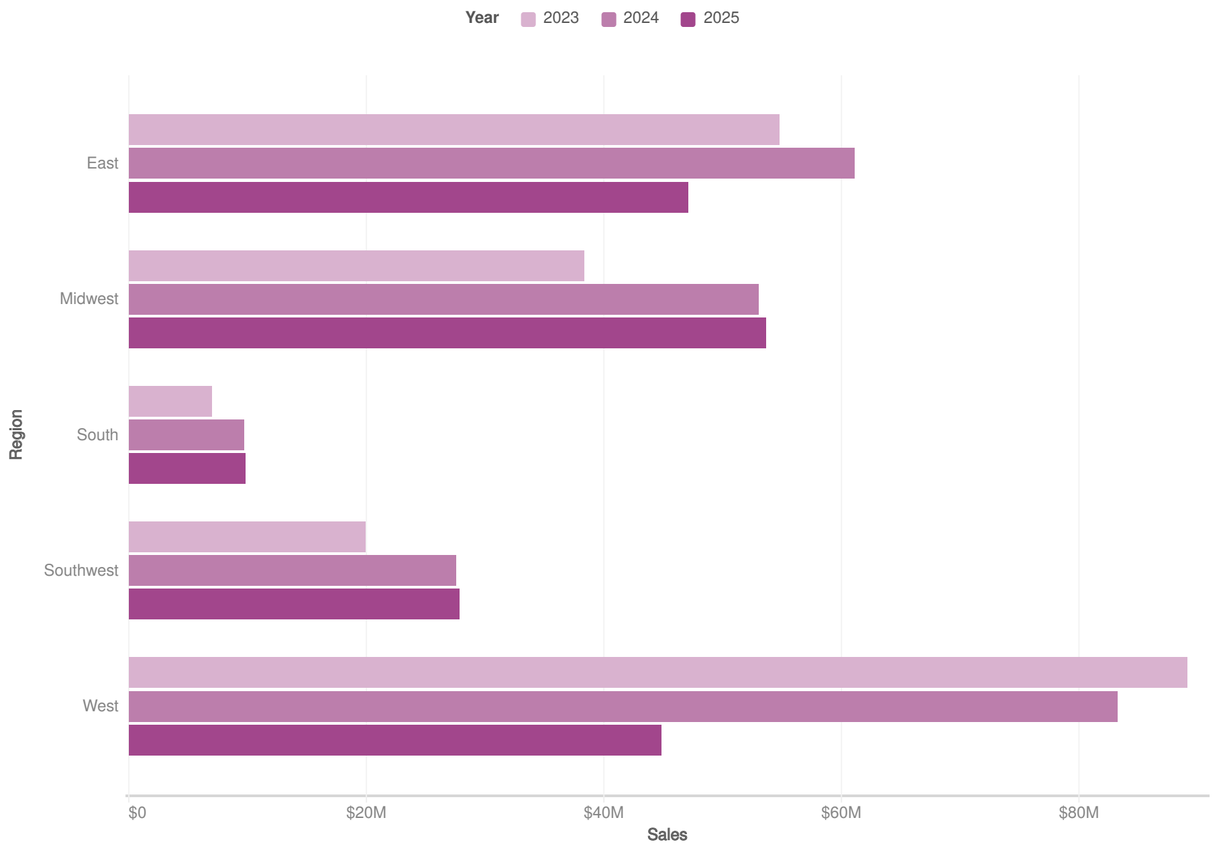
Column

Uses vertical columns on a common baseline to compare quantitative values across categories.



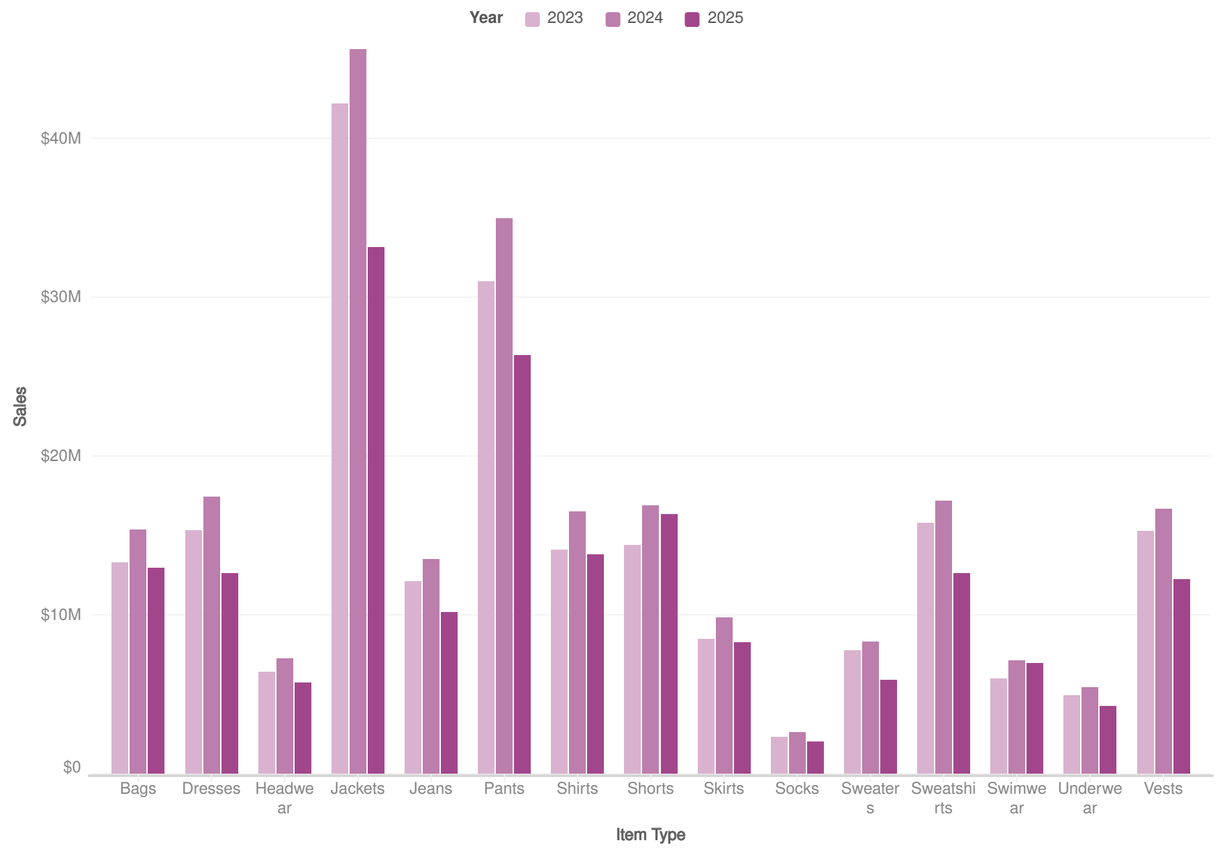
Grouped Bar

Clustered horizontal bars breaking down each category into sub-groups for multi-dimensional comparison.



Grouped Column

Places grouped vertical columns side by side to compare subcategories or time periods within each category.

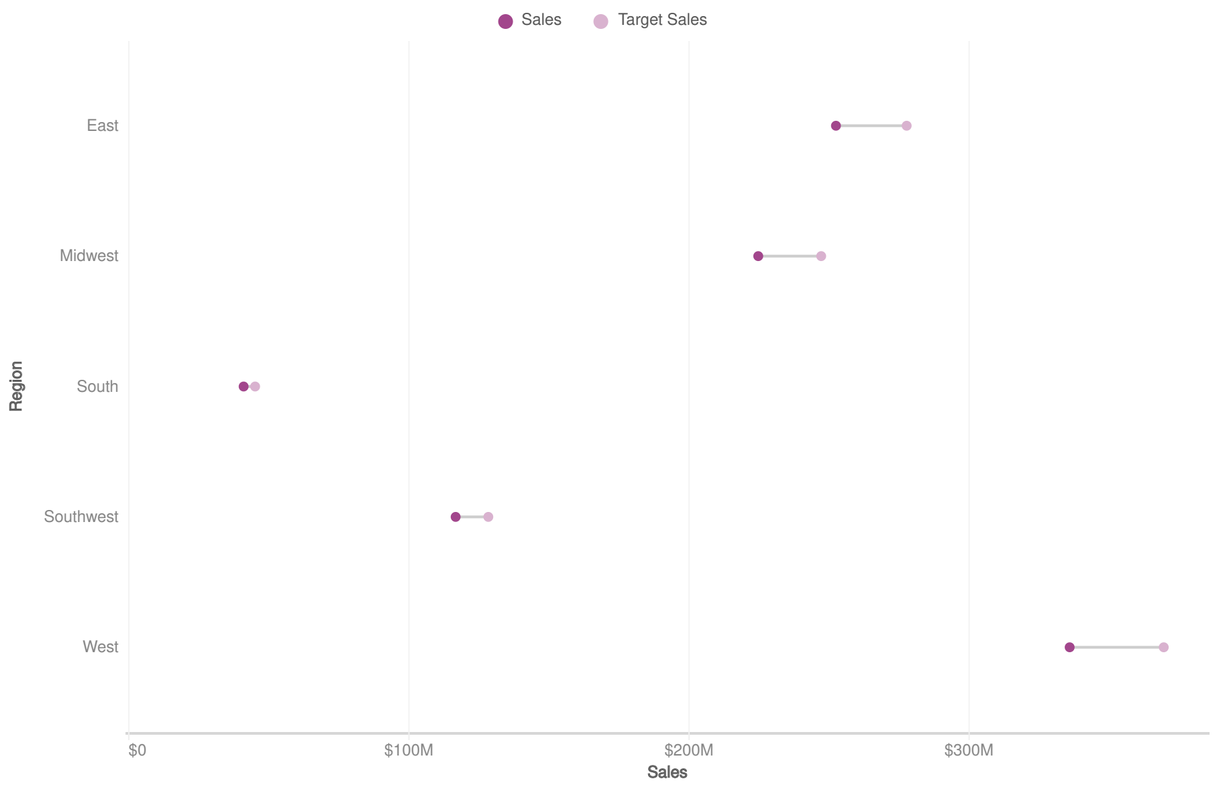


Advanced Magnitude Charts

Use dots and scaled symbols to compare magnitudes and highlight differences between related measures.

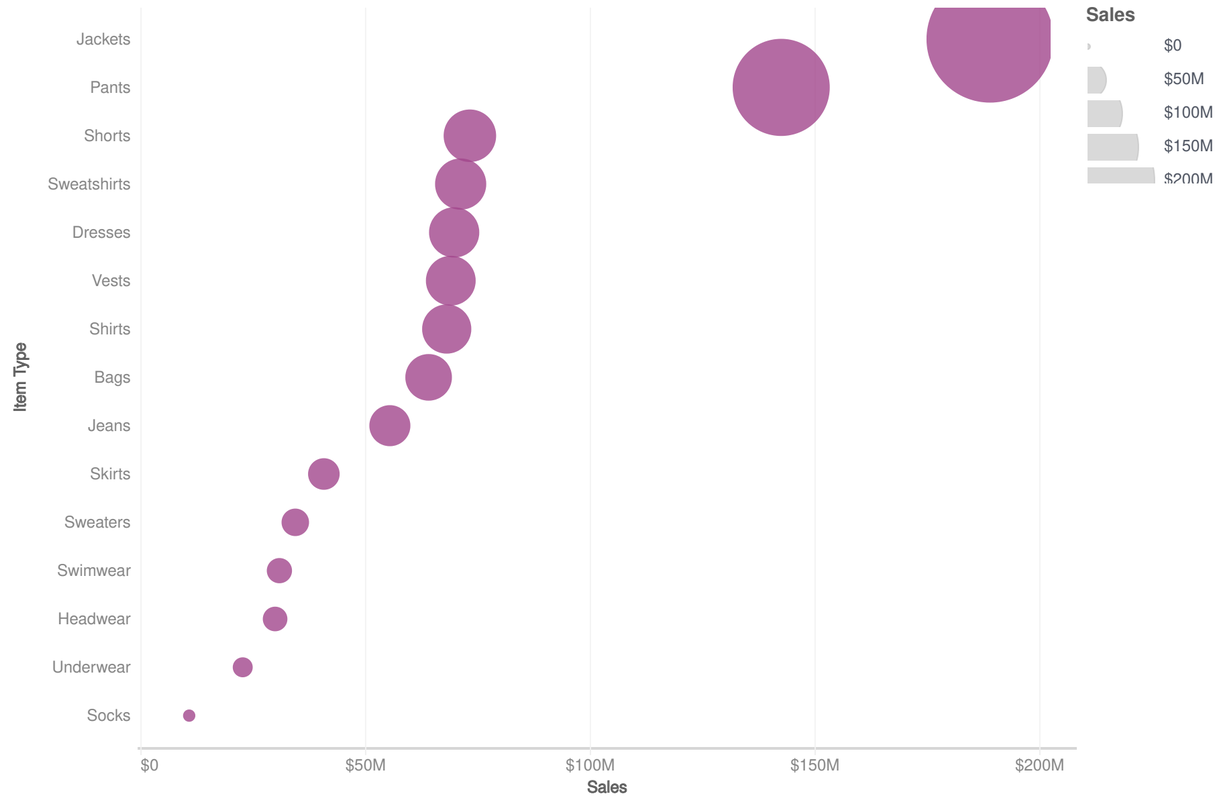
Dot Plot

Compares two measures for each category with connected dots to emphasize their differences and relative positions.



Proportional Symbol

Uses symbol size to encode a quantitative measure, highlighting relative magnitude across categories.



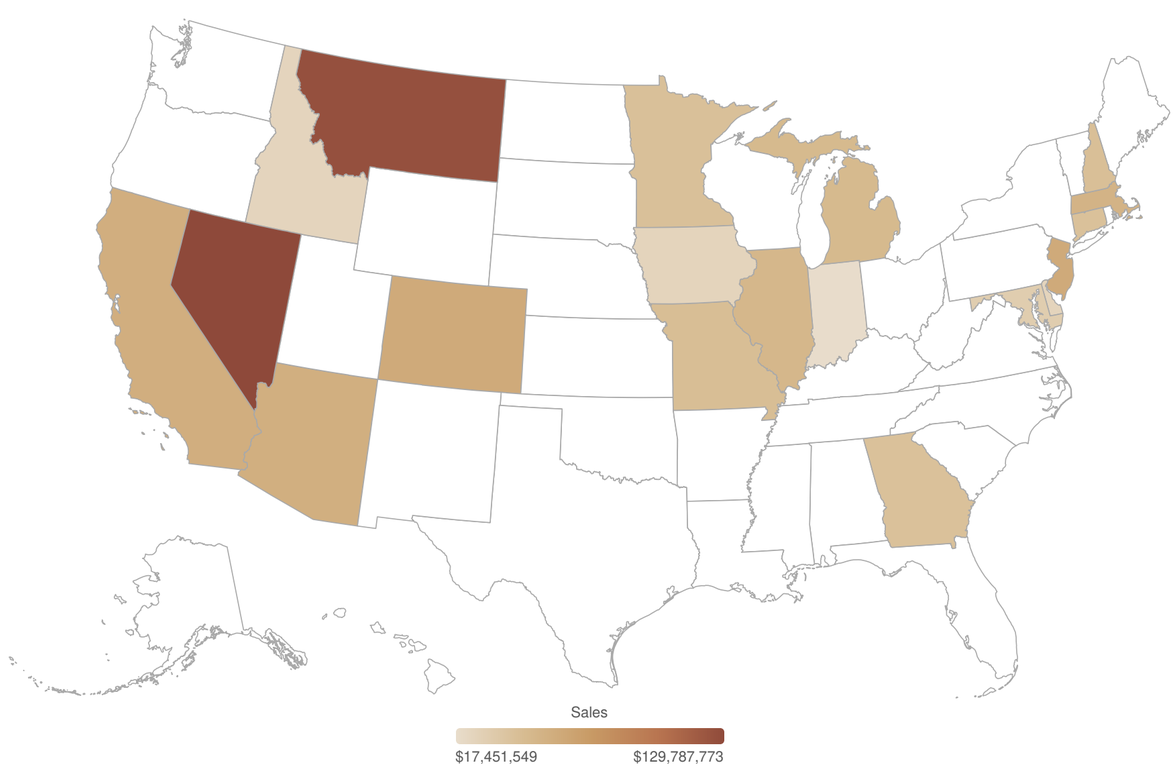
Spatial

Standard Spatial Charts

Use conventional maps to compare geographic areas, show individual locations, and display spatial magnitudes.

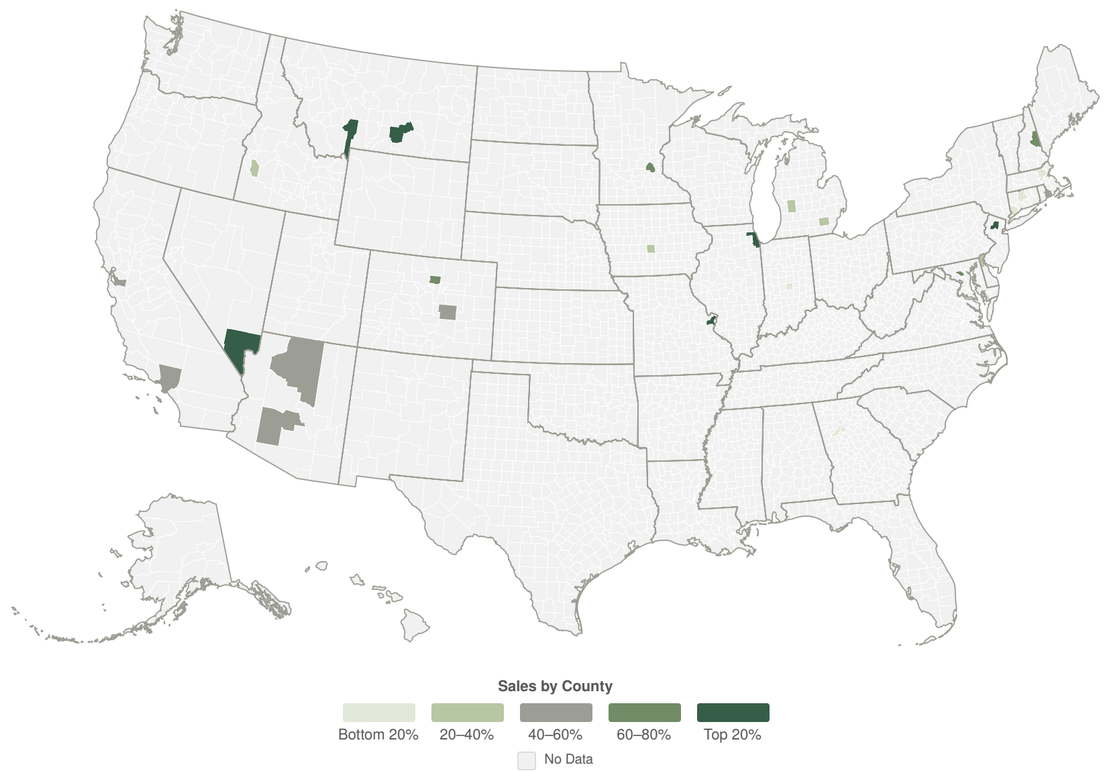
Geo Area Choropleth

Shades geographic areas according to a measure to compare regional patterns and differences.



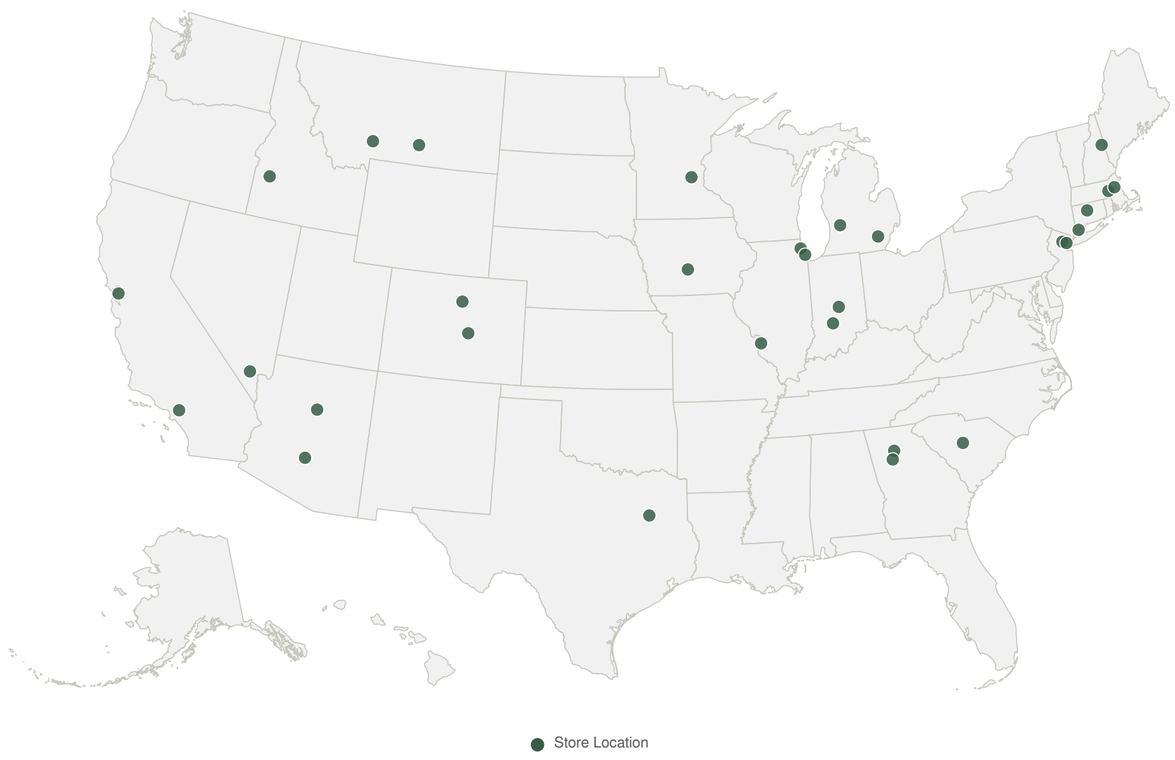
County Choropleth

Shades individual counties by sales volume to reveal geographic performance differences within states.



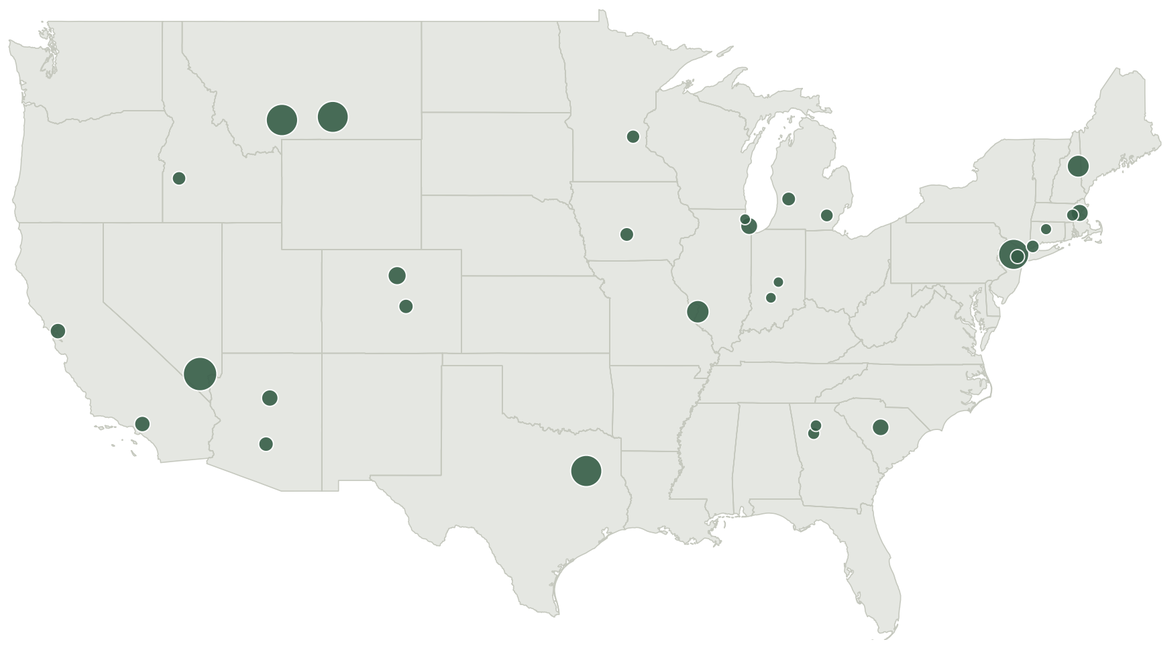
Dot Map

Plots individual observations at geographic coordinates to show precise locations and geographic distribution.



Geo Bubble Map

Places differently sized bubbles at geographic locations to compare spatial distribution and magnitude.

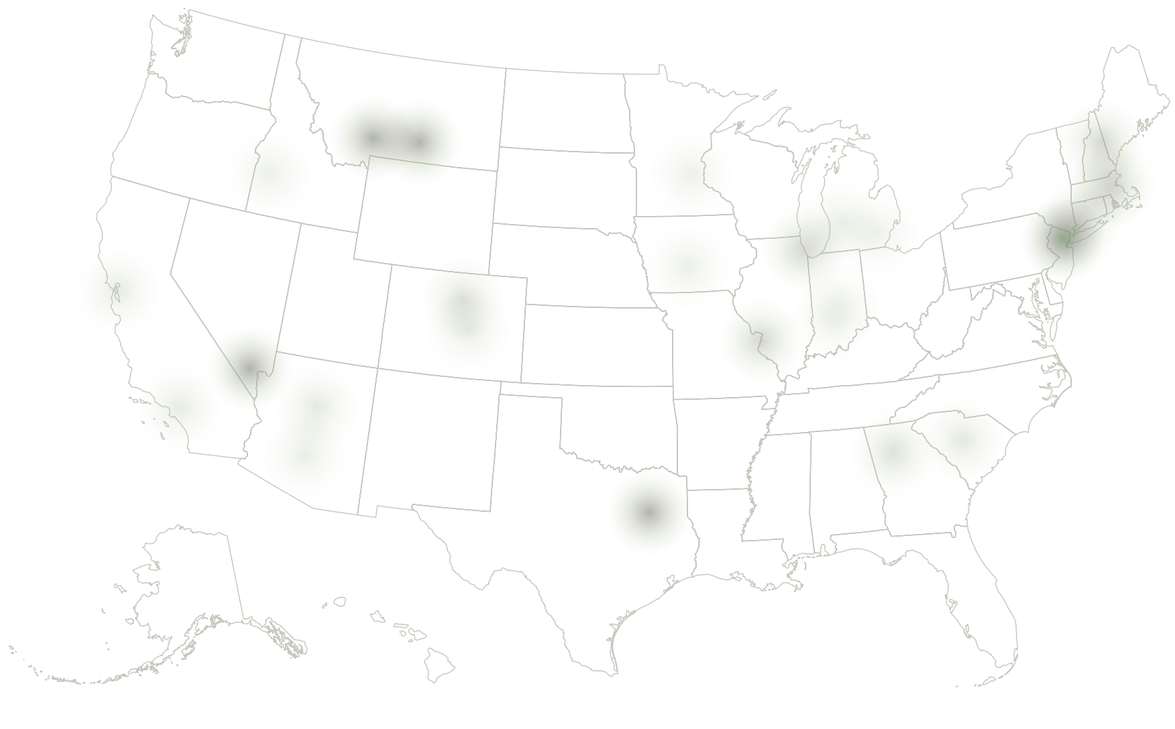


Advanced Spatial

Use spatial density, tile, and multivariate maps to reveal concentration, geographic structure, and paired measures.

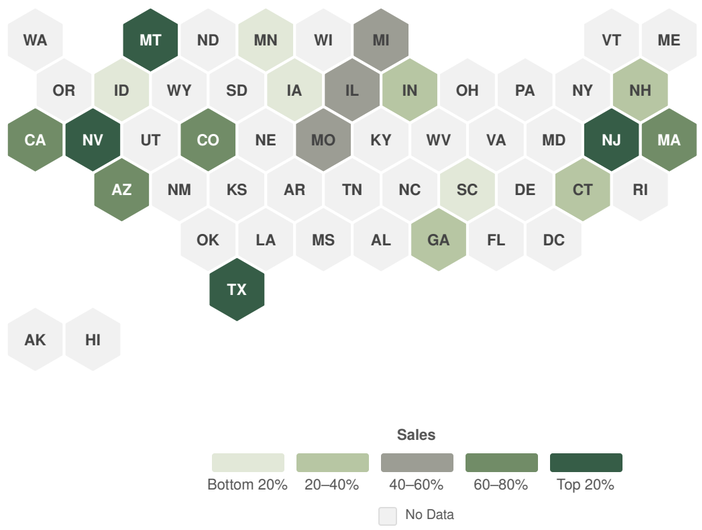
Geo Heatmap

Uses spatially smoothed color intensity to show where geographic observations or weighted activity concentrate.



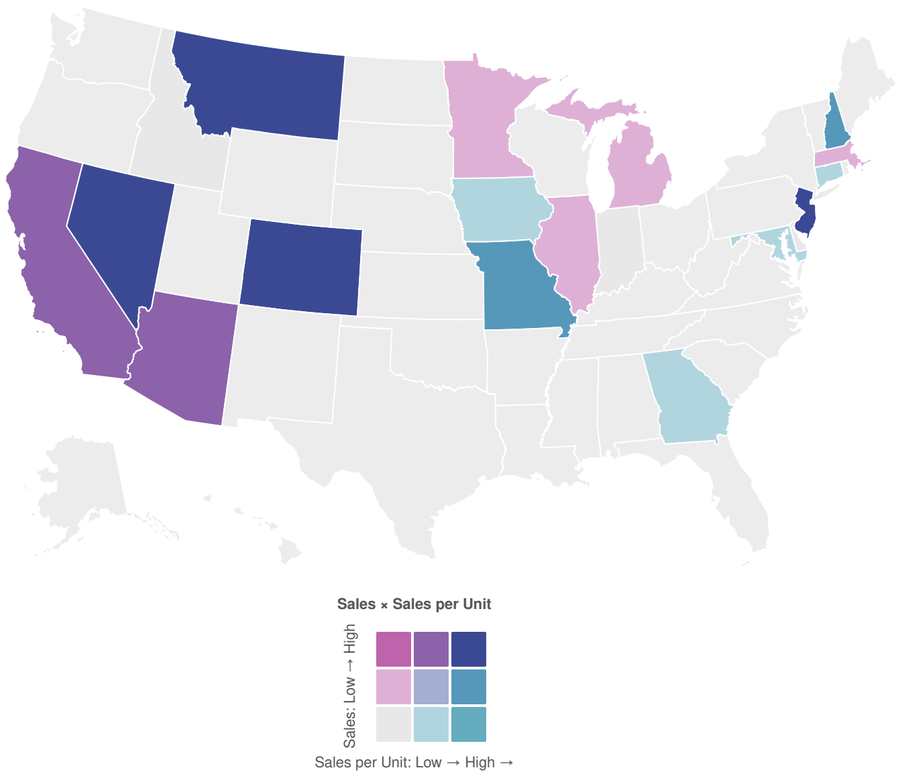
Hex Tile Map

Displays state-level sales using a grid of hexagonal tiles, making geographic comparisons easier without relying on traditional map…



Bivariate Choropleth

Encodes two measures, sales and sales per unit, on a single choropleth to compare volume and efficiency by state.



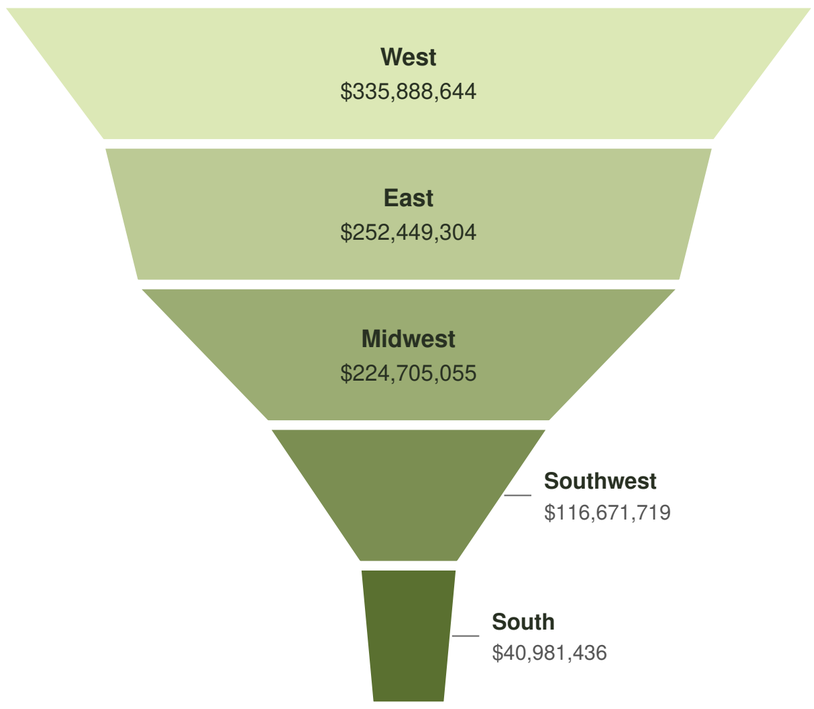
Flow

Standard Flow Charts

Use simple ranked and ribbon-based layouts to introduce category size and the distribution of values between groups.

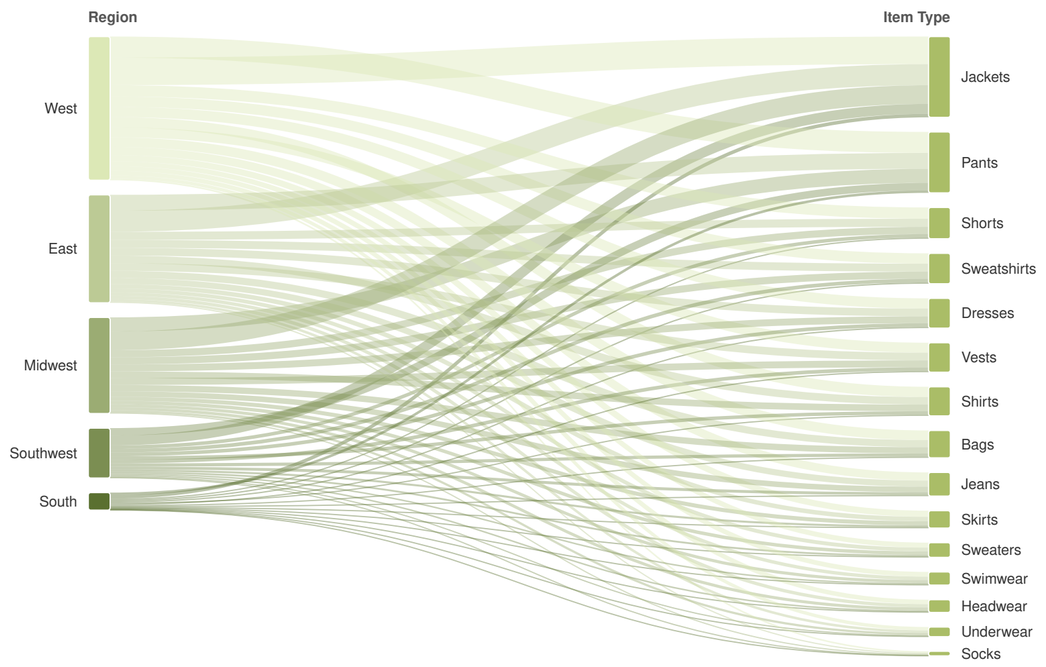
Ranked Funnel

Uses narrowing segments ordered by magnitude to compare ranked categories; unlike a process funnel, it does not imply stage…



Sankey

Uses connected ribbons of varying width to show how a quantity is distributed between two sets of categories.

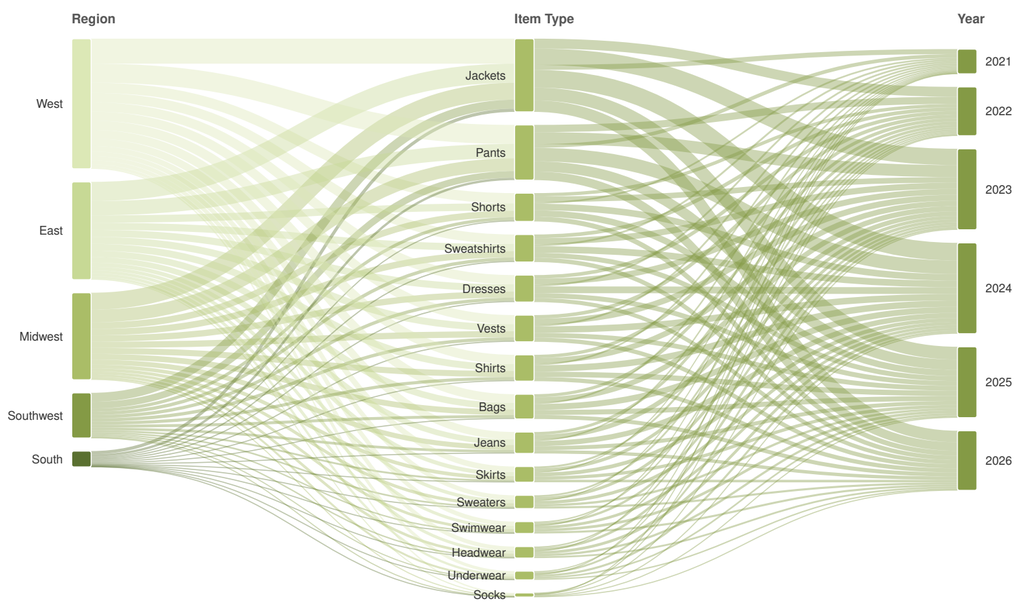


Advanced Flow Charts

Use multistage bands, chords, and networks to examine complex categorical connections and weighted relationships.

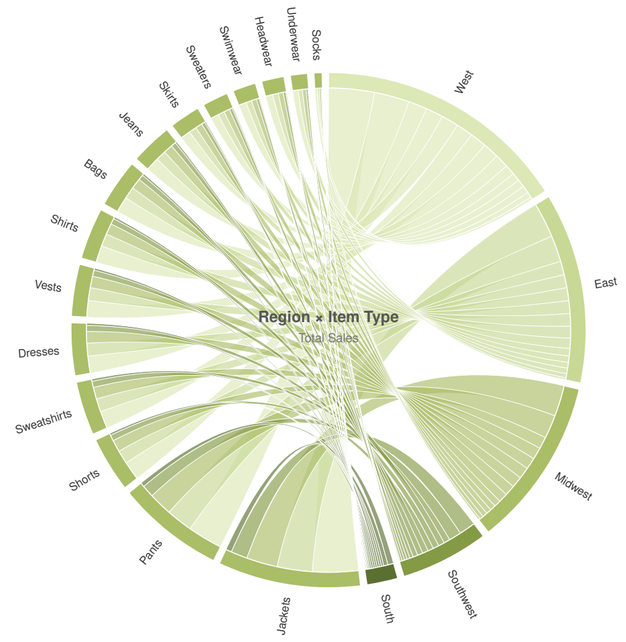
Alluvial Diagram

Connects categorical axes with proportional bands to compare distributions across multiple dimensions or stages.



Chord Diagram

Arranges categories around a circle with ribbons whose widths express the strength of relationships between them.



Network Flow Diagram

Displays connections between regions and item types, using node size and connection thickness to represent sales volume.

